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‘MANUFACTURE IN INDIA – FOR INDIA & THE WORLD’

FM invites global investors to set up mfg , tech, innovation bases in India

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Washington, August 29

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman invited global investors to set up manufacturing bases, and technology and innovation centres in India, urging them to leverage talent and opportunity to build for the world.

Addressing a high-level Business Roundtable with leading investors and business leaders in Chicago on Friday, She highlighted India's broad-based growth, reform momentum and expanding opportunities for long-term investment.

She emphasised that India's investment proposition rests not on any single sector, but on the convergence of scale, growth, talent, infrastructure, technology & sustained reform over the past decade.

“The policy environment is increasingly focused on enabling businesses to invest, manufacture, innovate and expand,” she said at the roundtable organised by India's Consulate General in Chicago



Union Finance and Corporate Affairs Minister Nirmala Sitharaman addresses a business roundtable with investors and business leaders, in Chicago, Illinois, United States.

PTI

in association with US-India Strategic Partnership Forum. Sitharaman invited global partners to co-develop, co-produce and build for global markets.

She urged them not to consider India merely as a market to serve, but as a platform from which to build for the world -- whether as a manufacturing base, technology and innovation centre, consumer market or destination for long-term infrastructure investment -- leveraging India's engineering talent, manufacturing scale and technology ecosystem.

The focus of the meeting was “Manufacture in India – for India and for the world”, with opportunities across manufacturing, AI & digital, financial services, infrastructure, food processing, defence and advanced technologies.

“As global companies reassess supply chains and capital allocation, India offers not only scale as a market, but increasing depth as a long-term investment and operating platform,” Sitharaman said.

The minister said India's Digital Public Infrastructure such as Aadhaar, UPI, Digil-

KEY POINTS

- » Sitharaman highlighted India's broad-based growth, reform momentum and expanding opportunities for long-term investment
- » She invited global partners to co-develop, co-produce & build for global markets
- » She urged them not to see India merely as a market to serve, but as a platform to build for the world

ocker, ONDC and India Stack, has created platforms at population scale.

“The next opportunity is to build higher-value businesses in AI, engineering, analytics, product development, semiconductors and electronics, with India's Global Capability Centres increasingly becoming global innovation hubs,” she said. Sitharaman said GIFT City was emerging as an international financial centre connecting global capital with Indian opportunities.

With 1,250 registered entities as of June 2026, it

offers opportunities across banking, fund management, reinsurance, aircraft and ship leasing, sustainable finance and other cross-border services, Sitharaman said, inviting global institutions to explore GIFT City as a gateway to India's financial ecosystem.

She said with global supply chains being reconfigured, India offers a compelling combination of a large domestic market and globally competitive manufacturing capabilities.

The focus is moving beyond assembly towards deeper component manufacturing, engineering and advanced technologies, supported by targeted policy measures including production-linked incentives, the minister said.

Sitharaman said India's infrastructure build-out - from dedicated freight corridors and railway modernisation to electrification and high-speed rail - offers opportunities across engineering, technology, materials, specialised equipment and long-term institutional capital.

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Mumbai, August 29

HDFC Bank CEO Jagdishan opts out of reappointment



HDFC Bank's MD and chief executive Sashidhar Jagdishan

HDFC Bank's managing director and chief executive Sashidhar Jagdishan on Saturday opted out of being considered for reappointment after his current term ends on October 26, the largest private sector lender said in a regulatory filing.

Jagdishan, 61, will retire from the bank on October 26 after spending nearly three decades at the lender.

After taking over as the bank CEO in October 2020, Jagdishan is serving his second three-year term as the lender's head.

The HDFC Bank board will fast-track the process for selection and appointment of Jagdishan's successor “well within time”, the exchange filing said.

He conveyed his decision not to seek reappointment as the Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer and also reiterated the decision despite “persuasion” from the board, it added.

“The board deeply appreciated his commitment, leadership, contribution to the growth and

stability of the Bank and his role in successful completion of one of the largest mergers in corporate India,” the filing said.

It also conveyed best wishes to Jagdishan in his future endeavours.

Jagdishan took over as the CEO of the bank from Aditya Puri, who had led the bank since its founding in 1995.

Within months, it announced the merger of its mortgage major parent, HDFC, with itself, leading to huge expansion in the asset book and worries over business performance, HDFC liability payouts and compressed net interest margins of the combined entity.

The management, however, said the merger will accrue benefits over the

long term.

The issue of Jagdishan's reappointment has been a subject of intense speculation, especially after the surprising resignation of non-executive chairman Atanu Chakraborty in March this year, citing concerns on ethics and governance practices at the lender.

In late July, the bank board found shortcomings in the deposit arrangements with the Maharashtra State Road Development Corporation (MSRDC) and also slapped a fine of Rs 1 lakh each on Jagdishan and other key executives, even though it said that their actions were not mala fide.

It was alleged that the bank paid, over and above the card rate, for getting high-value deposits from the state-run body and routed them as marketing spends.

Besides, the bank has also faced allegations of mis-selling Credit Suisse's AT-1 bonds to diaspora clients from its Dubai DIFC branch, which led the local regulator to prohibit the bank from onboarding new customers or conducting new business last year.

‘Noida airport may see slower ramp-up due to challenging global situation’

AGENCIES
Washington, August 29

Noida International Airport may see a “slower ramp-up” due to the challenging geopolitical environment, with near-term performance facing elevated uncertainty, its operator Zurich Airport International AG said.

The Jewar, Uttar Pradesh-based airport began operations on June 15, handling 204 flights and 25,000 passengers in June, followed by 1,044 flights and 77,000 passengers in July.

Zurich Airport said the route network will continue to expand, with international services expected to follow. It expressed confidence in the long-term growth potential of India's aviation market.

In H1 2026, the airport's revenue stood at CHF 2.5 million, while operating expenses were CHF 4.9 million. It incurred a loss of CHF 2.4 million before interest, taxes, depreciation and amortisation.

The airport has an initial capacity of 12 million passengers annually, with Phase 1 investment estimated at CHF 750 million.

Canara, Union Bank to challenge NCLT's nod to Chandra's plan

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 29

Canara Bank, Union Bank of India (UK) Ltd and LIC Housing Finance Ltd on Saturday said they will challenge the National Company Law Tribunal's (NCLT) order approving a repayment plan proposed by Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra over claims arising from his personal guarantees.

Canara Bank, which held a 1.60 per cent voting share, said it voted against the plan and will appeal

before the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal. It also sought a forensic audit, but said the request could not be allowed due to its minority voting share.

Union Bank of India (UK) said it had rejected the plan and would immediately challenge the NCLT order. LIC Housing Finance said it would file an appeal along with other public financial institutions. The lenders said the plan was approved as financial creditors holding 80.81 per cent of the voting share backed it.

The NCLT approved the

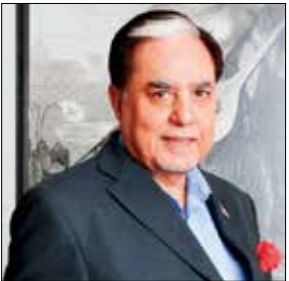
plan on August 25, under which Rs 6.25 crore will be paid to creditors and Rs 25 lakh towards insolvency-process costs, against admitted claims of around Rs 22,006.57 crore.

The proceedings relate to personal guarantees given by Chandra for borrowings by Essel Group-linked firms. Chandra rejected claims that he personally borrowed Rs 22,000 crore, saying they arose from corporate guarantees. Opposing lenders' claims total around Rs 3,992 crore.

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 29

Media baron Subhash Chandra said he plans to work with investment professionals in Switzerland and may borrow Rs 2-4 crore from his family to invest in start-ups, days after the National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) approved a repayment plan that will leave creditors with only a fraction of their claims.

“I have no regrets. I will earn again. I am a pioneer. I know how to



Subhash Chandra

do good and new things. I will continue to do so,” the 75-year-old Essel Group chairman said in a video statement.

Chandra said he cur-

rently has Rs 6.5 crore left, which will be used for repayment under the approved plan.

He also said he owns a small residential house that he has rented out and uses the rental income to meet his expenses.

“Right now, I have a plan to work with my friends in Switzerland who do investment work. I will give you the details in the next 1-2 weeks,” Chandra said.

He added that he might take a loan of Rs 2-4 crore from family and invest in

start-ups that have growth potential.

Chandra's Essel Group has interests spanning media, infrastructure and amusement parks.

Under the approved repayment plan, approximately Rs 6.5 crore will be available for distribution against admitted creditor claims of about Rs 22,006.57 crore.

This translates into a recovery of roughly 0.03 per cent of the admitted claims, leaving creditors with a haircut of nearly 99.97 per cent.

DRI seizes 18 kg drugs from Bengaluru, Pune

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 29

The Directorate of Revenue Intelligence (DRI) has seized over 18 kg of amphetamine and MDMA in two operations and arrested four persons, the Finance Ministry said on Saturday.

On August 25, DRI seized around 14.9 kg of amphetamine at Bengaluru's KSR Railway Station and 2.53 kg of amphetamine along with 878 grams of MDMA tablets at Pune Junction.

In Bengaluru, officers

intercepted an Indian woman travelling from New Delhi and recovered seven packets containing a crystalline substance that tested positive for amphetamine.

Three persons involved in transporting and receiving the contraband were arrested under the NDPS Act, 1985. In Pune, DRI intercepted another woman travelling from Hazrat Nizamuddin Railway Station and recovered the suspected drugs from her baggage. She was arrested under the NDPS Act.

FSSAI bans Everest, Laljee Godhoo from selling hing

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 29

Food regulator FSSAI on Saturday said it has prohibited Everest Food Products Pvt Ltd and Laljee Godhoo from selling hing powder, which it found to be sub-standard.

In a social media post, the Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) informed that it has issued prohibition orders against Everest Food Products and Laljee Godhoo and Company as their products ‘hing powder’ were found to be sub-standard.

In the case of Everest, FSSAI has prohibited the sale of compounded asafoetida (hing powder) variants with immediate effect.

“The samples of Compounded Asafoetida (Hing Powder) were found to be ‘Misbranded and Sub-standard’ by the Food Analyst of the primary food laboratory,” the regulator said.

The articles were found to be in contravention of the provisions of the FSS (Food Products and Food Additives) Regulations, 2011, wherein the alcohol soluble extract obtained was 0 per cent against the

prescribed standard of not less than 5 per cent.

“The samples of Yellow Hing Powder (Compounded Asafoetida) and Black Hing Powder (Compounded Asafoetida) were also found to be Sub-standard, with Alcoholic Extract reported at 3.29 per cent and 4.4 per cent, respectively,” it added.

The regulator has asked the company to submit an action plan to rectify continued malpractice of selling substandard compounded hing/asafoetida and ensure sale of standard products as licensed

under the FSS Act, 2006. It warned of further action if the company do not rectify mistakes.

In the matter of Laljee Godhoo, FSSAI said the company has been prohibited from selling hing powder, which it found to be sub-standard and adulterated, in contravention of FSSAI law. “The samples of Compounded Hing / Compounded Asafoetida (Powder and Lump) were found to be sub-standard and not conforming to the prescribed requirements under the FSS (Food Products & Food Additives)

Regulations, 2011. The compounded Hing samples were also found to be misbranded and Sub-standard,” it added.

The samples of raw hing varieties used in the manufacture of compounded Hing were found to be sub-standard due to the presence of excess starch, which must not exceed 1% by weight. FSSAI has asked Laljee Godhoo to submit an action plan for rectification of the malpractice and measures to ensure that only standard products are manufactured and sold in accordance with the FSS Act.

FSSAI proposes red labels for unhealthy foods Label would carry declarations like ‘High Fat’, ‘High Sugar’, ‘High Salt’

AGENCIES
New Delhi, August 29

The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has proposed prominent red front-of-pack warning labels for packaged food products high in added saturated fat, added sugar and salt, according to an affidavit filed before the Supreme Court.

The proposal seeks to provide consumers with a simple and easily understandable warning.

CLOSER LOOK

- » FSSAI proposed implementing the labelling system in phases. Phase I would cover products high in two or more specified nutrients and specified sweetened beverages
- » While Phase II would extend warnings to products high in any one nutrient

A red-coloured hexagonal label would be required on products high in any two or more of the three specified nutrients, based on thresholds under the Dietary Guidelines for Indians, 2024, issued by

ICMR-NIN.

The label would carry declarations such as “High Fat”, “High Sugar”, “High Salt” and/or “Highly Sweetened Beverage”, as applicable.

It would be displayed in

a font size one point larger than that used in the nutrition information table on the back of the pack.

The affidavit was filed in compliance with the Supreme Court's August 13 order while hearing a plea by public charitable trust 3S and Our Health Society seeking mandatory front-of-pack warning labels.

FSSAI proposed implementing the front-of-pack nutrition labelling system in phases.

Phase I would cover products high in two or

more specified nutrients and specified sweetened beverages, while Phase II would extend warnings to products high in any one nutrient.

Single-ingredient foods and inherently high-fat, sugar or salt products such as ghee, edible oil, salt, sugar, jaggery and honey are proposed to be exempted.

FSSAI said the proposed rules would be notified through amendments following the prescribed procedure.

DELHI GOVT DIRECTS INSPECTION
OF WATERLOGGING HOTSPOTS **P5**



'ACHIEVEMENTS MEANINGFUL ONLY
WHEN THEY ROOTED IN VALUES' **P7**

THE SONG OF VULNERABILITY
THAT STILL HAUNTS US **P14**



Nepal: 675 dead, thousands still missing

At least 287 Indians remain missing, 88 rescued after devastating flash floods



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Kathmandu, August 29

The death toll from flash floods in central Nepal rose to 675 on Saturday, with more bodies being recovered on Saturday even as more than 2,400 people still remained missing following the disaster.

Bodies were recovered from all eight affected districts as search and rescue operations continued on war footing, Nepal police said.

An ice-rock avalanche following a glacial collapse near the Nepal-Tibet border sent a torrent of water, mud and debris downstream wiping out towns and villages, damaging crucial infrastructure and washing away hydropower stations through central Nepal on Wednesday.

So far, 675 bodies of the Bhote Koshi flood victims have been recovered from eight districts, according to a statement by Nepal Police.

The rescuers have recovered 246 bodies from Chitawan, 165 from Nawalparasi East, 63 from Nawalparasi West and 57 from

Gorkha, it said.

Similarly, 45 bodies were recovered from Dhading district, 51 from Nuwakot, 35 from Tanahu and 13 from Rasuwa district.

More than 2,400 people remained missing as of Saturday.

Nearly 2,500 people, including 163 foreigners, were evacuated as rescue teams led by the National Disaster Risk Reduction and Management Authority (NDRRMA) raced against time amid on-and-off rainfall in the flood-affected regions.

More than 11,000 security personnel, including over 5,000 Nepal Army personnel, have been mobilised for search and rescue operations.

The NDRRMA, in a statement, urged people not to fly drones in the flood affected area, where search and rescue operations are being carried out.

"Our attention has been drawn that there are reports about flying drone by some individuals and organisations without the permission from the local administration at a time when rescue and relief works are in progress," it said.

CONTINUED ON P6

DEEPENING TIES

PM's Tashkent stop, SCO Summit next...



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Tashkent, August 29

Prime Minister Narendra Modi arrived in Uzbekistan on Saturday, where he will hold delegation-level talks with President Shavkat Mirziyoyev, aiming to further strengthen the strategic partnership between the two countries.

President Mirziyoyev welcomed PM Modi on arrival at the airport in Tashkent. This is PM Modi's fourth visit to Uzbekistan.

"Landed in Tashkent to a warm welcome by President Shavkat Mirziyoyev. Grateful to him for the special gesture. This is my

HIGHLIGHTS

» During his two-day visit to Uzbekistan, Modi will discuss cooperation in trade, investment, digital connectivity, defence, and energy sectors with President Mirziyoyev

» From Tashkent, the prime minister will travel to Bishkek to participate in the 26th SCO Summit, at the invitation of the President of the Kyrgyz Republic, Sadyr Zhaparov

fourth visit to Uzbekistan, reflecting the depth and growing momentum of our bilateral

CONTINUED ON P6

Russia hits Kyiv, 37 dead

KYIV: At least 37 people have been killed following a Russian strike close to the Ukrainian capital of Kyiv, officials said Saturday, one of the deadliest attacks to hit Ukraine this year.

The attack sparked a fire in the Bucha district, west of Kyiv, that swept through homes and damaged at least 50 residential buildings, said Tymur Tkachenko, head of the local regional military administration.

SEE P4

FSSAI proposes red flags on food

NEW DELHI: The Food Safety and Standards Authority of India (FSSAI) has told the Supreme Court that it has proposed to provide a prominent front-of-pack warning label in red colour for food products which are high in added saturated fat, added sugar and salt.

In a compliance affidavit filed in the apex court, the FSSAI said the proposal is intended to provide a simple, prominent and easily comprehensible warning to consumers regarding food products which are high in specified nutrients of concern.

"It is proposed to provide a prominent front-of-pack warning label in a red-coloured hexagonal shape for food products which are high in any two or more of the following nutrients of concern, namely added saturated fat, added sugar and salt, based on the thresholds specified under the Dietary Guidelines for Indians, 2024 issued by ICMR-NIN," the affidavit said.

It said the warning label should indicate the applicable declarations, such as "High Fat", "High Sugar", "High Salt" and/or "Highly Sweetened Beverage", as the case may be, to enable consumers to readily identify products high in the specified nutrients.

SEE P2

IT'S A CRIME: RAHUL

'Purification' of Kharage rally site: LoP seeks FIR

AAISHA SABIR

New Delhi, August 29

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Saturday demanded that the Centre and Uttarakhand government should immediately register an FIR and initiate action against those who performed 'shuddhi-karan' (purification) at the venue in Haldwani where Congress president Mallikarjun Kharage addressed a rally on August 8.

Gandhi attacked the BJP-RSS over the 'shuddhi-karan' (purification) ceremony carried out at the venue of a rally, saying it was a "crime", and Prime Minister Narendra Modi must order the registration of an FIR in the matter.

The Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha said this incident shows the BJP-RSS mindset that they do not want the Dalits to progress and live with respect and be successful.

"We are demanding jus-



KEY POINTS

» The Leader of Opposition in Lok Sabha said this incident shows the BJP-RSS mindset that they do not want the Dalits to progress and live with respect and be successful

» 'We are demanding justice for the Congress president. Give the Congress president justice in Uttarakhand'

tice for the Congress president. Give the Congress president justice in Uttarakhand. It is the duty of the central and state governments to ensure that Kharage gets justice," he said at a press

CONTINUED ON P6

SIR: 47.7 lakh voter names to be left out

Claims window opens Monday

OUR CORRESPONDENT
New Delhi, August 29

Nearly 47.7 lakh voter names out of 1.45 crore are likely to be left out of the draft electoral roll to be published on Monday under the Special Intensive Revision, with the final roll due on November 4.

Those excluded in the draft roll can seek inclusion by filing claims and objections from August 31 to September 30, officials said.

The draft roll will contain around 97.5 lakh electors, whose enumeration forms were submitted and digitised during the door-to-door exercise that concluded on August 17, accounting for 67.18 per cent of Delhi's 1.45,10,299 electors, according to figures released by the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer (CEO).

The remaining 47.7 lakh electors have been marked "uncollectable"

THOSE EXCLUDED IN THE DRAFT ROLL CAN SEEK INCLUSION BY FILING CLAIMS AND OBJECTIONS FROM AUG 31 TO SEPT 30

and placed in the "Absent, Shifted, Dead, Duplicate and Others (ASDDO)" categories. They will not appear in the draft roll but can seek inclusion by filing claims and objections from August 31 to September 30, officials said.

The publication of the draft will also begin the next phase of scrutiny, with some electors whose names figure in the roll likely to receive notices if their details could not be linked to the 2002 intensive revision roll or if anomalies were detected in their enumeration forms, officials said.

CONTINUED ON P6

Hindu who thinks there should be no Muslim in India is not Hindu: Bhagwat

MPOST BUREAU

New York/New Delhi, August 29

RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat emphasised religious harmony while speaking at a multi-faith dialogue in New York on Saturday, where he addressed a question about the place of Muslims in the organisation's vision of a 'Hindu Rashtra'.

"If you want to call yourself Hindu, you must believe that all paths are leading to the same goal. And every human has dignity. There is no difference between human beings," Bhagwat said.

Recalling an earlier interaction with members of the Muslim community, Bhagwat said he had been asked whether Muslims would be driven out of India because the RSS advocates the idea of a 'Hindu Rashtra'. "I said, 'No, that is not Hindutva'," he said.

BJP chief summons 3 Delhi MPs

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

New Delhi, August 29

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Saturday summoned three party MPs from Delhi -- Kamaljeet Sehrawat, Ramvir Singh Bidhuri and Yogender Chandolia -- and

expressed displeasure over their visit to former Congress MP Sajjan Kumar's residence to offer condolences after his demise.

Kumar, who was serving two life sentences in connection with the 1984 anti-Sikh riots, died at

Safdarjung Hospital here on August 20.

BJP MPs Sehrawat, Bidhuri and Chandolia recently visited Kumar's residence to pay condolences. "BJP national president Nitin Nabin summoned

CONTINUED ON P6



Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) Sarsanghchalak Mohan Bhagwat speaks at 'One World, One Humanity' faith leaders' conference, in New York, on Saturday

PTI

He added that anyone who believes there should be no Muslims in India would be contradicting the principles of Hindutva.

65 BILLION BARRELS, ONE BIG DEAL

Venezuela's oil goes America's way...

ASSOCIATED PRESS

Washington, August 29

President Donald Trump on Friday said the US has entered an agreement with Venezuela to take control of 65 billion barrels of the South American country's oil reserves.

Trump in a social media post announced the agreement he said was negotiated by Secretary of State Marco Rubio, Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Venezuela's interim President Delcy Rodriguez.

"The United States of America has just entered into an Agreement with the Country of Venezuela on, THE BIGGEST OIL DEAL IN WORLD HISTORY!" Trump wrote.

The announcement of the deal comes nearly nine months after the US military at Trump's direction carried out an operation to capture Venezuela's president



Nicolás Maduro and spirit him to the United States to face federal narcoterrorism and drug trafficking charges.

Trump faces mounting pressure to address high gas prices as the war in Iran reaches a six-month milestone with no conclusion in sight. The US has tapped its strategic petroleum reserves,

which in early August fell below 300 million barrels, down by more than 100 million barrels since the start of 2026.

In the days following Maduro's ouster in January, Trump floated the idea of US oil companies returning to Venezuela to tap its oil reserves. Trump has argued that Venezuela stole US oil when

OIL POWER PLAY

» The agreement allows for the United States to partner with an unnamed private operator in Venezuela to create a new private company to take hold of the reserves

» 'Rodriguez granted the company 100-year rights to develop the oil fields'

» THE DEAL GIVES THE UNITED STATES 55 PER CENT EFFECTIVE OUTPUT OF THE NEW PRIVATE COMPANY -- INCLUDING AN OWNERSHIP STAKE AND RIGHTS TO BUY OIL AT COST



former Venezuelan President Hugo Chavez's moved decades ago to nationalize hundreds of foreign-owned assets, including those owned by American oil companies.

Venezuela has one of the largest oil reserves in the world, with an estimated 303 billion barrels of crude oil in the ground.

CONTINUED ON P6

DURING TMCP MEETING

FIR against Mamata over 'HC order breach'

OUR CORRESPONDENT
Kolkata, August 29

The Trinamool Chhatra Parishad's (TMCP) foundation day celebrations have now turned into a police case, with Kolkata Police registering a suo motu FIR against former West Bengal chief minister Mamata Banerjee and the event organisers for allegedly flouting conditions laid down by the Calcutta High Court for the August 28 programme on Cathedral Road.

The case was registered under Sections 61(2) (criminal conspiracy), 223 (disobedience of an order duly promulgated by a public

servant), 125(a) (causing hurt by an act done rashly or negligently as to endanger human life or personal safety), 132 (assault or criminal force to deter a public servant from discharging their duty) and 285 (danger or obstruction in a public way or line of navigation) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

According to the complaint lodged by SI Apu Baidya of Hastings police station, Banerjee and the TMCP organisers allegedly entered into a criminal conspiracy and provoked supporters.

The crowd allegedly pushed aside barricades and jostled

CONTINUED ON P6



News at a glance

Zimbabwe minibus taxi crashes, killing 27

HARARE: A collision between a minibus taxi carrying church members and a haulage truck killed 27 people on Friday in Zimbabwe, a police spokesperson said, in the latest road disaster to hit the southern African country.

Paul Nyathi, the police spokesperson, said on Saturday that members of a popular indigenous African Christian denomination, known for wearing white robes, were travelling for a conference when the minibus taxi collided head-on with the truck Friday night.

Army chief visits Pak’s largest defence industrial complex

ISLAMABAD: Pakistan’s army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir on Saturday visited the country’s largest defence industrial complex to see its production and export capabilities.

Pakistan Ordnance Factory (POF) in Wah is located about 41 km west of capital Islamabad.

According to a statement by the army, Munir’s visit to “Pakistan’s largest defence industrial complex”, focused on reviewing production capabilities, export potential and contributions towards the country’s defence industrial base.

Europe’s summer drought threatens fish in rivers, lakes

NOVI SAD: Small boats stand idle on cracked ground in a shrivelled side channel of the Danube River in northern Serbia, where the water has receded into a couple of shrinking ponds under pressure from extreme drought and heat. Fish circle in the shallow waters.

“This is all we have, these two little ponds that are full of juvenile fish,” fisherman Dusan Jovanovic said. He said the fish are in danger because there is too little water and its temperature is over 30 degrees Celsius (86 degrees Fahrenheit).



A truck lies overturned and partially buried in thick mud following flash floods, in Nepal PTI

Briefs

Will observe 25th anniv of 9/11: Trump

WASHINGTON: President Donald Trump will mark the 25th anniversary of the Sept 11 attacks at the Pentagon.

Trump confirmed his plans Friday. Vice President JD Vance will attend the New York observance and other administration officials will go to the ceremony in Shanksville, Pennsylvania, the White House said.

Colorado River plan to cut water

PHOENIX: On the outskirts of Phoenix, a small town with a huge reliance on the Colorado River has capped growth, revived old wells and struck water deals.

But Cave Creek Mayor Robert Morris can’t shake the real possibility that it’s not enough to keep the desert community of about 5,000 people afloat well into the future. And a recent federal plan to address a deepening crisis in the river basin won’t help.

Ecuador: Ex-Prez sentenced to five years

QUITO: Former Ecuadorian President Lenin Moreno was sentenced Friday to 5 years in prison after a court found him guilty of accepting bribes from a Chinese company in exchange for helping it secure a contract to build a hydroelectric plant. Moreno, who was present for the reading of the verdict, is 73 years old and has a physical disability that prevents him from walking.

Pak: Gunmen attack injures three cops

PESHAWAR: Three security personnel were injured on Saturday after unidentified gunmen opened fire at a police vehicle in northwest Pakistan, police said.

The banned terror outfit Tehreek-e-Taliban Pakistan claimed responsibility for the targeted attack in the Tank district of the restive Khyber Pakhtunkhwa province. The attackers ambushed the police vehicle on the Dera Ismail Khan Road near the Chakan area, police said.

KYIV INVESTIGATES WAREHOUSE TARGETED IN ATTACK

Russian strike near Kyiv kills 37, in one of year’s deadliest attacks

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Kyiv, August 29

At least 37 people have been killed following a Russian strike close to the Ukrainian capital of Kyiv, officials said Saturday, one of the deadliest attacks to hit Ukraine this year.

The attack sparked a fire in the Bucha district, west of Kyiv, that swept through homes and damaged at least 50 residential buildings, said Tymur Tkachenko, head of the local regional military administration.

Kyiv investigates warehouse targeted in attack

In a statement on the attack, Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said that a warehouse had been struck in the village of Myla, “followed by a detonation.”

He did not give details on the site, but wrote in the same message that Ukrainian law forbade the storage of ammunition close to civilian homes and that criminal proceedings had been opened.

“Those who allowed this to happen must be held accountable for their decisions,” Zelenskyy said.

The Ukrainian leader also wrote that a care home for elderly people



A view of a destroyed car stands amid damaged buildings after a Russian attack struck a warehouse, followed by an explosion, in the village of Myla, Kyiv region, Ukraine, Saturday AP/PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said that a warehouse had been struck in the village of Myla, “followed by a detonation
- » Those who allowed this to happen must be held accountable for their decisions,” Zelenskyy said Putin claimed the two leaders had hammered out

and people with disabilities had been damaged, and that an evacuation from the area was ongoing. Ukrainian Prime Minister

Serhii Koryntskyi also didn’t offer information on the warehouse targeted, but referenced an attack on the Kyiv suburb

of Vyshneve early in July, which hit an ammunition depot, killing 22 and triggering large detonations and fires that tore through nearby homes.

“Unfortunately, we can already see that the tragedy in Vyshneve did not become a lesson,” Koryntskyi said. “In the fifth year of a full-scale invasion, making the same mistakes is criminal negligence. And all those guilty, without exception, must be severely punished so

that such situations do not happen again.”

In a statement, Russia’s Ministry of Defence said that it had hit a warehouse in Myla storing components and launch boosters for long-range drones.

It also said that it had attacked the ports of Mykolaiv and Izmail, as well as a logistics centre and warehouse facilities storing parts for Ukraine’s Flamingo cruise missiles in the Kyiv region.

Trump announces setting up Space Academy

AGENCIES
Washington, August 29

US President Donald Trump announced the formation of a new military Space Academy and interacted with astronauts onboard the International Space Station, including Anil Menon, during a visit to NASA’s Mission Control at Houston.

“This is a great honour, to be with you is a great honour and I just want to thank Jessica, Anil, Jack - great Americans, great patriots, brave people,” Trump said, making a call to the orbital laboratory from the Mission Control at Johnson Space Centre on Friday.



NASA astronauts Jack Hathaway, Anil Menon, and Jessica Meir are part of Expedition 75 to the International Space Station.

Trump called the crew a group of “pioneers” for their efforts in space exploration.

After his brief remarks, Trump had NASA astronaut Anna Menon, Anil Menon’s wife, and Duke Brady, Jessica Meir’s husband, briefly interact with the ISS crew.

“Hi, it’s Anna. Great to see you guys up there. We love you guys. You’re doing

a great job,” she said.

The President also offered to welcome the astronauts to the White House when they return.

Menon, a colonel in the US Space Force, told Trump he was proud to serve in space and shared his experiences about the spacewalk he completed earlier this week.

Trump also announced the formation of the new Space Academy - a “top line” school with tough admission standards and a “beautiful” campus to train the next generation of civilian and military aerospace experts.

of the Basij, the Revolutionary Guard’s volunteer street force, which played a major role in crushing January’s nationwide protests, when thousands were killed.

That post went to Hossein Taeb, a hard-line cleric and longtime intelligence chief who led one of the first major crackdowns on protests, in 2009. His appointment is seen as a sign that the leadership is intent on preventing any new unrest as discontent over the economy spreads.

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Niger’s security forces battle mutinous soldiers in capital

A group of soldiers rebelled against officers at key military base

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Niamey, August 29

A group of soldiers in Niger rebelled against officers at a key military base and fired at sensitive locations in the capital, Niamey, in an apparent mutiny and threat to the country’s struggling junta, authorities said Saturday.

Sustained gunfire and explosions were heard overnight into Saturday, including at Niamey’s main airport that houses the military air base and in a district where the presidential palace is located. Security forces were deployed to key locations. Since a coup in 2023, the impoverished West African country of more than 25 million people has severed ties with longtime Western security partners, turning instead to Russia. But the junta has been unable to stem jihadi violence and rampant killing of security forces, fuelling unrest within the military, observers say.

By Saturday afternoon, several analysts and two witnesses said the situation in the city remains tense. The whereabouts of Niger’s military leader, Abdourahmane Tchiani, who seized power following the coup, were not immediately clear.



SUSTAINED GUNFIRE AND EXPLOSIONS WERE HEARD OVERNIGHT INTO SATURDAY IN THE CITY, INCLUDING AT THE MAIN AIRPORT THAT HOUSES THE MILITARY AIR BASE

Niger’s Defence Minister Gen. Salifou Mody said a group of soldiers took some officers hostage at the base and shot at “sensitive sites” in a “break with the discipline and military regulations.”

The Defence and Security Forces were able to “gradually regain control of these sites,” Mody said.

Security forces were deployed around the airport and in the Plateau district, while a major road leading to Niamey was closed. Many residents remained indoors over safety concerns.

‘Profound consequences’: Pak warns over water deprivation

AGENCIES
Islamabad, August 29

Pakistan has said that any attempt to deprive it of waters allocated under the Indus Waters Treaty will have “profound consequences” for regional security, according to a media report.

Deputy Prime Minister Ishaq Dar, while virtually addressing a seminar on “The Indus Waters Treaty: South Asian Security at the Crossroads,” also said that the issue was beyond bilateral relations and concerned “the sanctity of treaties.”

The 1960 vintage Indus Waters Treaty (IWT) is a World Bank-brokered agreement between India and Pakistan governing the sharing of waters of the six rivers of the Indus basin, allocating the three eastern rivers to India and the three western to Pakistan. India has put it in “abeyance” since April 2025 in response to the Pahalgam terror attack.

“The treaty contains no provision permitting either party to unilaterally suspend or place it in abeyance,” Dar said, adding that neither country could “through a unilateral political declaration, extinguish obligations solemnly undertaken under international law.”

IRAN IS DETERMINED TO SMOTHER ANY INTERNAL UNREST

Even after six months, Iran’s leaders defying US

ASSOCIATED PRESS
Dubai, August 29

After six months of war, Iran’s leadership has coalesced around a hard core of military generals and clerics long entrenched in the ruling theocracy. They are ready for a potentially long confrontation with the US and determined to prevent any unrest at home.

It’s a far cry from US President Donald Trump’s initial hopes of toppling the Islamic Republic and

his subsequent claims that “regime change” had brought more compromising officials to the fore.

Iran’s new leaders evince little faith in any agreement with Trump - after coming under attack twice while holding talks - and they may be bracing for another assault once the US replenishes its supplies of interceptors. They have also threatened to escalate the war as a continuing American blockade and Trump’s plans for new sanctions threaten to suffocate Iran’s already worsening economy.

“If (Trump) wants to do something, we will retaliate in a seismic manner,” the new secretary of Iran’s Supreme National Security

CLOSER LOOK

- » It’s a far cry from Trump’s initial hopes of toppling the Islamic Republic and his subsequent claims that “regime change” had brought more compromising officials to the fore
- » Rezaei’s appointment came in a recent set of decrees by the supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei

cate Iran’s already worsening economy.

“If (Trump) wants to do something, we will retaliate in a seismic manner,” the new secretary of Iran’s Supreme National Security

Council, Mohsen Rezaei, said last weekend. In a post on X, he said that “if the economic war continues, not a single drop of oil will be exported” from the Persian Gulf.

Rezaei’s appointment came in a recent set of decrees by the supreme leader, Ayatollah Mojtaba Khamenei, that formally set Iran’s new senior leadership, including top military posts. Khamenei’s father and much of the highest echelons were killed in the bombing campaign launched by the US and Israel on February 28. Perhaps most telling was the newly named head

The measures reflect the civic body's "focus on improving cleanliness, waste removal, public safety and green cover through sustained, zone-wise action".

SURVIVED THE FLOODS, SPENT 2 DAYS WATCHING TRISHULI RAGE

Nepal floods: Tea break saved lives of 5 Chhattisgarh friends

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Raipur, August 29

But for a tea break, five friends from Chhattisgarh could have been swept away in the flash floods that devastated Bhote Koshi and Trishuli river valleys in Nepal on Wednesday.

They survived, but then had to spend two anxious days watching the fury of the swollen Trishuli river from an elevated spot.

Narayan Sen, Dinesh Ojha, Prem Singh Jagat, Yatendra Prakash and Dinesh Singh Thakur, all aged between 50 and 60 years and residents of Mana Camp area in Raipur, returned home on Saturday.

“We were lucky that we stopped for tea on August 26 when the flash floods struck. If we had left 10-15 minutes earlier, we might have got trapped,” Narayan Sen (53) who runs a salon, told PTI Videos.

“Had we not stopped there, we do not know what would have happened,” he said.

The group had left Raipur on August 21 and reached Nepal the following day. They had hired a car and were planning to visit the Pashupatinath Temple, Manokamana Temple and other tourist attractions.

At around 9.30-10 am on August 26, they stopped for tea at a hotel in Malekhu town of Dhading district.

“There we learnt that a bridge ahead had been



HIGHLIGHTS

- » Narayan Sen, Dinesh Ojha, Prem Singh Jagat, Yatendra Prakash and Dinesh Singh Thakur, all aged between 50 and 60 years and residents of Mana Camp area in Raipur, returned home on Saturday
- » The group had left Raipur on August 21 and reached Nepal the following day. They had hired a car and were planning to visit the Pashupatinath Temple, Manokamana Temple and other tourist attractions

washed away in a flood. The hotel belonged to an Indian, who helped us a lot and provided us food,” Sen said.

The friends became eyewitness to an unfolding disaster.

“We saw cars being swept away in the Trishuli river. Bodies and a lot of other things were also being carried away by the current. We were scared. There was always a fear that the flood situation might worsen,” Sen said.

The group took shelter

at a higher spot at Malekhu and spent the night in their car. Local residents and authorities helped them.

Thakur (55), a police head constable, said they were around 50 km from Pashupatinath Temple when the flood struck.

“While having tea at the hotel, we noticed people suddenly becoming restive. Later, we learnt about the devastation caused by the flood. We heard that entire villages, buildings, offices and hydropower projects

had been devastated,” he said.

They later visited the bank of the Trishuli river to see the situation for themselves. “What we saw is very difficult to describe in words,” said Thakur.

“We kept chanting Lord Shiva’s name, and we feel his blessings protected us,” he added.

Thakur praised the local administration and police. “There was no electricity and water, but the administration and police helped

us. They told us that we were at a higher place and should not worry,” he said.

The group remained in touch with their families through the internet, and used the helpline provided by the Indian government to share their location.

“Internet service was working well there, so we remained in contact with our families and did not panic,” Thakur said.

The friends finally left Nepal on August 28.

Amid the tragedy, the five friends shared a tender moment when local women security personnel tied rakhis on their wrists.

“We were supposed to return from the trip after the Rakhi festival, so our sisters had already given us rakhis. The women security personnel deployed there tied these rakhis on our wrists. That was the most comforting moment,” Thakur said.

Dinesh Ojha, who runs a tailoring shop, said the scenes they witnessed after the flood would stay with them forever.

“We will never be able to forget what we saw. Many people were desperately searching for their missing family members,” he said.

“We slept in our car, but we could not really sleep. There was always the fear that another flood might come,” Ojha said.

“We are happy that finally we have reached back home,” he added.

Flood threat looms in Bihar

MPOST BUREAU
Patna, August 29

Flood fears increased in Bihar on Saturday as persistent rains in Nepal and the state pushed water levels above danger marks in several rivers, already swollen by flash floods in the neighbouring Himalayan nation earlier this week.

According to the Water Resources Department, the Gandak river has breached the danger mark in Gopalganj, with a barrage on the river in Valmikinagar releasing around 99,800 cusecs of water at 8 pm on Saturday.

Wednesday’s flash flood in Nepal, triggered by an ice-rock landslide, has led administrations in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar to step up monitoring of their river systems downstream of the rivers of the Himalayan nation.

“The water level of several rivers, including the Gandak, Kosi, Burhi Gandak and the Ganga, has been rising. Incessant rainfall in the catchment areas of Nepal has led to rivers touching or flowing above the danger level at several places,” a senior official of the Water Resources Department said on Saturday.

The Kosi and Burhi Gandak have touched the danger level in Khagaria, Katihar and Kursela, while the Ganga was flowing above the danger mark at Hathidah and Gandhighat in Patna and Kahlgaon in Bhagalpur, according to a bulletin from the Water Resources Department.

BJP chief chairs youth outreach, poll prep meet

MPOST BUREAU
New Delhi, August 29

BJP president Nitin Nabin on Saturday held a crucial meeting with party leaders to discuss and formulate its youth outreach plan, sources said.

According to sources, the party’s preparations for the upcoming assembly polls in seven states, including Uttar Pradesh, Punjab and Gujarat, were also on the agenda.

The meeting was attended by newly appointed BJP Yuva Morcha president Hemang Joshi. Former presidents of the party’s Yuva Morcha Anurag Thakur, Poonam Mahajan and Tejasvi Surya were also present.

Union Minister for Information and Broadcasting Ashwini Vaishnaw, Youth Affairs and Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya and Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia participated in the meeting.

Former Union minister and newly appointed BJP national general secretary Smriti Irani, Gujarat Deputy Chief Minister Harsh Sanghavi and Chhattisgarh Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Sharma were among the leaders present.

The BJP invited more than 40 party leaders from across the country to participate in the closed-door discussions, according to sources.

There was no official



word from the party on what transpired in the meeting.

This comes ahead of a month-long ‘Seva Sankalp Abhiyan’ to be launched by the BJP across the country from September 17 to mark the completion of Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s 25 years in public life as the head of a government and his contributions.

The decision was taken at the party’s first meeting with all 67 newly appointed national office bearers on August 22, which was also attended by the presidents and organising general secretaries of the BJP’s state unit, besides other senior leaders of the party.

During the nationwide campaign, the BJP will reach out to every section of society, including youth, women and farmers through various programmes.

From page 1

Nepal: 675...

The Authority warned of legal action if the law is breached.

Meanwhile, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) said on Saturday that at least 287 Indians remained missing while 88 others were rescued following the devastating flash floods along the Nepal-Tibet border four days back.

It said 128 persons of Indian origin have also been uncontactable. The MEA also said that 120 Indian nationals stranded on the Chinese side have safely crossed over to Nepal on Saturday.

Four Indian nationals – Ripu Kumar, Chaneshwar Narzary, Kripa Shankar and Mohammed Minhajuddin – were rescued from a hydropower project in Rasuwa, it said, adding they are expected to reach Kathmandu soon.

Rasuwa was among the areas severely impacted by the floods.

The death toll from Wednesday’s flash floods in Nepal rose to 675 with more bodies recovered as search and rescue operations continued, according to the latest details shared by Nepalese authorities.

The MEA said India sent a six-member team of forensic experts to Nepal on Saturday to help local authorities to analyse DNA samples for identification of mortal remains of those killed in the floods.

India has also sent a specialised technical team for tunnel reconnaissance and rescue to the neighbouring country as part of its support.

“The team started working from today to assist in tunnel rescue in the impacted area. Based on their recommendation, a specialised tunnel rescue team from India with equipment is expected to reach Nepal today,” the MEA said on social media.

It said 88 Indian nationals were rescued and 287 remained missing as of Saturday.

Meanwhile, an 11-member Indian team arrived in Nepal’s flood-affected Trishuli area in Nuwakot district on Saturday to assist in efforts to rescue workers trapped in a tunnel belonging to a hydropower project.

The team, comprising medical personnel and tunnel-rescue specialists, arrived in Nepal on Friday.

After completing an aerial survey of the Chilime and Langtang areas, the Indian team began necessary rescue-related work around the tunnel area, according to the National Disas-

ter Risk Reduction and Management Authority.

Based on the team’s recommendations, a specialised rescue team with equipment was expected to arrive in Nepal on Saturday night, the authority said.

An 82-member joint security team comprising Nepal Army, Armed Police Force and Nepal Police personnel has been working since Friday night to clear debris and reach people believed to be trapped inside the tunnel.

Rescue efforts have been complicated by mud and debris blocking the tunnel entrance and adverse weather conditions.

PM’s Tashkent...

relations,” PM Modi posted on X after arrival.

He visited Yangi Uzbekiston Park and laid a wreath at the Independence Monument after arrival. President Mirziyoyev accompanied Modi to the monument established on the 30th anniversary of the country’s independence, symbolising the ideals of freedom and goodness.

Modi is in Tashkent on the first leg of his two-nation visit that also includes the Kyrgyz Republic, aiming to strengthen India’s strategic partnerships in Central Asia and deepen the civilisational connect with the region.

During his two-day visit to Uzbekistan, Modi will discuss cooperation in trade, investment, digital connectivity, defence, and energy sectors with President Mirziyoyev.

“I look forward to my discussions with President Mirziyoyev on further deepening our cooperation in trade and investment, digital connectivity, defence, energy, and on advancing our shared visions of ‘Viksit Bharat’ and ‘Yangi Uzbekistan’,” Modi said in his departure statement.

Modi said he will also visit the Shastri Memorial and the Mahatma Gandhi Centre at the Tashkent State University of Oriental Studies, a tribute to the close cultural and people-to-people ties that bind the two countries.

From Tashkent, the prime minister will travel to Bishkek to participate in the 26th SCO Summit, at the invitation of the President of the Kyrgyz Republic, Sadyr Zhaparov.

‘Purification’...

conference here. Gandhi also accused the Uttarakhand BJP chief

Mahendra Bhatt of defending the purification act and said 20 days have passed since the “crime” was committed, but no action has been taken.

“We demand that an FIR be lodged against those who have done this. PM Modi states that he belongs to every caste and is the prime minister of the country, but his party chief of Uttarakhand defends shuddhikaran,” Gandhi said.

“There is a fight between two ideologies – the Constitution given by the likes of BR Ambedkar, Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru on one side, and the BJP-RSS on the other side,” he said.

“For thousands of years, violence was perpetrated against Dalits. This is illegal under the Constitution, but today also in schools, Dalit children are made to clean toilets. This is the reality of the country,” Gandhi said.

“Dalits are not allowed to drink water from wells. In tea shops, there are two cups – paper ones for Dalits and glass ones for others,” Gandhi said.

Citing the examples of Congress president, party’s Rajasthan leader Tikaram Jyoti and NDA minister Jitan Ram Manjhi – who all reportedly faced ‘purification’ situations at different times – Gandhi said the more successful the Dalit person is, the attack on him or her is more fierce.

“This is another name for untouchability. The BJP people practice untouchability. When they do shuddhikaran, they say that Dalits cannot touch as they are impure,” Gandhi said.

“They did shuddhikaran on August 10, two days after the rally of Kharge ji in Haldwani. This is a crime. On August 13, Kharge ji raised this issue in Parliament,” Gandhi recalled.

Uttarakhand Congress chief Ganesh Godiyal has alleged that the Shri Ram Sena had performed the purification ceremony and it was associated with the BJP, a charge denied by the ruling party.

SIR: 47.7 lakh...

A Delhi CEO official said such anomalies could include a mismatch between an elector’s name in the current roll and the 2002 roll, an age gap of less than 15 years or more than 50 years between an elector and a parent, or a gap of less than nine months between the birth dates of siblings.

The Electoral Registration Officer (ERO) may seek additional documents where there are doubts about an elector’s age or citizenship, the official said. Aadhaar alone will not be sufficient to establish eligibility.

The documentary requirements will also vary according to an elector’s date of birth.

Those born in India before July 1, 1987, will need a document establishing their date and/or place of birth; those born between July 1, 1987 and December 2, 2004, will need documents for themselves and one parent; and those born after December 2, 2004, will need documents for themselves and both parents, officials said.

The scale of exclusions has varied sharply across Delhi’s 70 Assembly constituencies. Rohini recorded the highest digitisation of enumeration forms at 83.43 per cent, while Tughlakabad recorded the lowest at 52.15 per cent, according to the CEO’s data.

Among minority-dominated constituencies, Okhla had 1,64,435 of its 3,62,813 forms, or 45.32 per cent, marked uncollectable.

Chandni Chowk recorded 38.98 per cent, followed by Ballimaran at 32.65 per cent, Mustafabad at 28.09 per cent, Babarpur at 27 per cent, Matia Mahal at 24.50 per cent and Seelampur at 23.37 per cent.

BLOs had earlier reported difficulties in linking residents in areas such as Shaheen Bagh and Jasola Vihar with the 2002 roll, particularly among migrant families from Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Assam and West Bengal.

At the other end, several constituencies recorded relatively high digitisation. Shakurbasti stood at 81.26 per cent, Rajouri Garden at 79.14 per cent, Mangolpuri at 78.76 per cent and Uttam Nagar at 77.76 per cent.

Among the minority-dominated seats, Seelampur recorded 76.63 per cent digitisation, Matia Mahal 75.50 per cent, Babarpur 73 per cent, Mustafabad 71.91 per cent and Ballimaran 67.35 per cent, while Chandni Chowk recorded 61.02 per cent.

The SIR exercise has simultaneously brought changes to Delhi’s polling-station network. The number of polling stations has increased from 13,033 to 14,947, while the number of polling-station locations has risen from 2,696 to 2,856.

The changes follow the Elec-

tion Commission’s decision to reduce the maximum number of electors assigned to a polling station from 1,500 to 1,200 for voters’ convenience.

North East Delhi now has the highest number of polling stations at 1,829 across 321 locations, while New Delhi has the lowest at 214.

The claims and objections filed after publication of the draft will be examined before the notice and disposal process concludes on October 29. The final electoral roll is scheduled to be published on November 4, according to the revised EC schedule.

BJP chief...

these three MPs today and expressed his displeasure over their visit to Sajjan Kumar’s residence,” a source in the party said.

BJP leader and senior Supreme Court advocate HS Phoolka hailed Nabin for taking a strong stand on the issue and said, “This is what leadership should look like, as opposed to the hypocrisy of the Congress all these years.”

“Grateful to Nitin Nabin for taking a strong stance on the issue,” Phoolka said in a post on X.

“BJP has fought for this issue as their own for 40 years,” he added in an apparent reference to the 1984 anti-Sikh riots.

Phoolka had on Friday condemned the visit of BJP MPs Sehrawat, Bidhuri and Chandolia to Kumar’s residence, calling for their boycott.

“Strongly condemn the visit of 3 MPs Kamaljeet Sehrawat, Ramvir Singh Bidhuri and Yogender Chandolia to mass murderer Sajjan Kumar’s residence to offer condolences on his death,” the BJP leader said in a post on X on Friday, sharply reacting to their visit.

“This when BJP has always supported our quest for justice against this culprit and supported us in ensuring that he stays in jail. Sympathy should be reserved for victims and their families-many of whom live the horror of those days even till now,” he added.

Phoolka, a former Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) member who is best known for representing 1984 anti-Sikh riots victims in their quest for justice, joined the BJP on April 1.

BJP spokesperson RP Singh also condemned the three party MPs for visiting Kumar’s residence.

Venezuela’s...

That’s about 17 per cent of the world’s supply, according to the US Energy Information Administration.

Unlike other parts of the world, where geologists have to search for untapped oil, the reserves under Venezuela’s soil are largely mapped and known, experts say. But because of dilapidated infrastructure, the country only produces about 1 per cent of the world’s oil.

The agreement allows for the United States to partner with an unnamed private operator in Venezuela to create a new private company to take hold of the reserves, according to a U.S. official familiar with the contours of the deal.

The official, who was not authorised to comment publicly and spoke on the condition of anonymity, added that Rodriguez granted the company 100-year rights to develop the oil fields.

The deal gives the United States 55 per cent effective output of the new private company – including an ownership stake and rights to buy oil at cost. The company would be the second largest corporate holder of proven reserves after Saudi Aramco, according to the official.

The announcement comes nearly nine months after the U.S. military at Trump’s direction carried out an operation to capture Venezuela’s then-President Nicolas Maduro and spirit him to the US to face federal narcoterrorism and drug trafficking charges.

Mamata...

with police personnel deployed to maintain law and order, while vehicular movement along one flank of Cathedral Road was obstructed. Police also alleged that the programme continued beyond the time permitted by the High Court.

The High Court had allowed separate TMCP foundation day programmes by two Trinamool Congress factions, with the Ritabrata Banerjee-led faction permitted to hold its event on Rani Rashmoni Road and the Mamata Banerjee-led faction on one side of Cathedral Road.

Attendance was capped at 1,500, with both programmes permitted between noon and 3 pm and one flank of each road required to remain open to traffic.

Briefs

‘Results for CSIR UGC-NET declared’

NEW DELHI: The results for the Joint CSIR UGC-NET have been declared, the National Testing Agency (NTA) said on Saturday.

“Results are now declared for Joint CSIR-UGC NET June 2026,” NTA said in a post on X.

The Council of Scientific & Industrial Research (CSIR), known for its cutting-edge R&D knowledge base in diverse S&T areas, is a contemporary R&D organisation. On Friday, the results of the UGC National Eligibility Test (NET) for 84 subjects were announced, with more than 4,000 candidates qualifying for the Junior Research Fellowship.

‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ in Indore

INDORE: Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi will address the Congress’ proposed ‘Chhatron Ki Goonj’ programme in Indore on September 12, with the party preparing to mobilise around 50,000 students for the event.

Indore city Congress committee president Chintu Chouksey said on Saturday that Gandhi would interact with students and youth, and raise issues concerning education during the programme.

The party is preparing to bring around 50,000 students from Indore and neighbouring areas to the proposed event, Chouksey said.

Maha: PSI dies ends life in Hingoli

MUMBAI: A 50-year-old Police Sub-Inspector (PSI) allegedly died by suicide after jumping in front of a speeding train on the outskirts of Hingoli town in Maharashtra on Saturday morning, an official said.

The incident occurred around 8.30 am, the police said, adding that Gangalwad, dressed in his official uniform, jumped before an Akola-bound passenger train coming from Purna near the Khatkali bypass area.

J’khand: Two mowed down

RANCHI: At least two labourers died, and three others were injured after a speeding truck hit them in Jharkhand’s Ranchi district on Saturday morning, police said.

The accident occurred on National Highway 33 near Rampur under the Namkum Police Station limits, when the labourers were repairing the road, a senior officer said.

‘NO POWER IN WORLD CAN STOP YOU SUCCEEDING’

Achievements meaningful only when rooted in values: Rajnath

OUR CORRESPONDENT Lucknow, August 29

Education that merely provides a degree without developing character has little value and is incomplete, Defence minister Rajnath Singh said on Saturday.

Addressing the 11th convocation ceremony of the Babasaheb Bhimrao Ambedkar University here, Singh said achievements become meaningful only when they are rooted in values.

“When education only gives a degree but does not develop character, such education has no value, it is incomplete,” the member of Parliament from Lucknow said.

He urged students to cultivate a broad mind and avoid jealousy, saying a person’s happiness and fulfilment increase with the broadening of his outlook.

“A pure mind belongs to one whose mind is broad. A person with a narrow mind can never have a pure mind,” he said.

Recalling former prime minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee’s words, Singh said, “No one becomes great with a small mind, and no one can stand with a broken spirit.”

He also referred to the struggles faced by B R Ambedkar and said the



Defence minister Rajnath Singh holds a sword during the inauguration of Fragrance Park and the unveiling of the statues of freedom fighters Lala Lajpat Rai and Shaheed Bhagat Singh, in Lucknow, Saturday PTI

KEY POINTS

- » Rajnath urged students to cultivate a broad mind and avoid jealousy, saying a person’s happiness and fulfilment increase with the broadening of his outlook
- » Singh said the journey to success often passes through four stages -- ‘people first ignore you, then laugh at you, oppose you and finally, praise your success’

social reformer chose education rather than violence or blaming his fate, despite facing discrimination.

“Ambedkar was not allowed to drink water from the tap from which

all the children drank. Despite suffering so much injustice, instead of cursing his fate or choosing the path of violence, he chose the path of education and returned to India to inspire people to bring

about change,” he said.

Singh said the world today is amazed by India’s success and its space capabilities, and the transformation has not happened because of “any miracle”, but is a result of the hard work and dedication of young people, scientists and engineers.

The senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader said the journey to success often passes through four stages -- “people first ignore you, then laugh at you, oppose you and finally, praise your success”.

He urged students not to be discouraged by people who may ignore, ridicule or create obstacles for them and instead, to move forward with confidence.

“I assure you that no power in the world can stop you from succeeding,” he said.

The defence minister said the quality, accessibility and affordability of education have improved in the country over the last 12 years, while the research-and-development infrastructure has also expanded.

CM Saini reviews development works

MPOST BUREAU Chandigarh, August 29

Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini while chairing the 32nd meeting of the Mewat Development Board held on Saturday at the Mini Secretariat in Nuh district headquarters, said that Nuh district is rapidly moving towards becoming a major hub for employment and self-employment opportunities for the youth.

Chief Minister said Nuh was included under the Aspirational Districts Programme, under which NITI Aayog has so far approved 12 projects worth Rs 36.20 crore.

Various important issues, including education, health, sports, irrigation, sewerage and cyber security, were discussed during the meeting.

During the meeting, a budget of about Rs 30 crore was approved under the Annual Action Plan for the financial year 2026-27.

The Chief Minister



said that development works worth about Rs 10.06 crore have been approved for strengthening the education sector in Nuh district.

These include providing dual desks in government schools, setting up Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics (STEM) labs in 20 government schools, scholarship schemes and providing coaching to students, among other initiatives.

Under social infrastructure development, about Rs 4.50 crore will be spent on the renovation of the stadium at Pingwan and development of a public park on the premises of the old court complex in Nuh.

Maratha activist Jarange begins fast

OUR CORRESPONDENT Mumbai, August 29

Quota activist Manoj Jarange launched an indefinite hunger strike on Saturday, demanding that the Maharashtra government immediately issue caste certificates based on the 58 lakh Kunbi records identified earlier and asserted that the community will not grant any further time.

Speaking to reporters at Antarwali Sarati village in Jalna district, Jarange warned that this would be his “final agitation” and accused Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis of bearing a “grudge” against the Maratha community and Deputy CM Eknath Shinde of quietly supporting him.

He also demanded the elimination of the caste verification committee, and threatened to march to the Chief Minister’s residence in Mumbai if the government fails to resolve all pending quota issues.

CM Yadav meets Shah, pitches MP’s development and cooperative push

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA New Delhi, August 29

Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav on Saturday met Union Home and Cooperation minister Amit Shah at his residence in New Delhi and briefed him on the implementation of welfare schemes, the progress of key development projects and initiatives to strengthen the cooperative sector in the state.

During the meeting, Yadav apprised Shah of the status of various public welfare programmes being implemented by the state government and shared details of new initiatives and innovations in the cooperative sector, an official statement said.

The Chief Minister also discussed the progress of important development projects and initiatives aimed at accelerating the state’s overall growth.



Madhya Pradesh Chief Minister Mohan Yadav with Union Home minister Amit Shah, in New Delhi MPOST

Yadav sought Shah’s guidance and continued support for taking forward the state’s development agenda.

He said Madhya Pradesh was making steady progress in development and public welfare under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and with the guidance of the central leadership.

The meeting assumes significance as the state government has been laying

Facing eviction, people meet Rahul seeking intervention

People from three slum clusters near the Prime Minister’s residence meet LoP Gandhi

OUR CORRESPONDENT New Delhi, August 29

People from three slum clusters near the Prime Minister’s residence on Saturday met Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi seeking his intervention against their proposed relocation to Savda Ghevra on the outskirts of Delhi, claiming the move would disrupt their livelihood, children’s education and access to healthcare.

Residents of Bhai Ram Camp, Masjid Camp and DID Colony, who gathered at the AICC office on 24 Akbar Road, claimed that around 717 families, comprising nearly 3,000 to 5,000 people, living in the three clusters will be affected.

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday granted these residents six weeks to vacate their homes and relocate to alternative accommodation at Savda Ghevra, rejecting the appellants’ claim that the process of their eviction violated the Delhi Slum and JJ Rehabilitation and Relocation Policy, 2015.

A bench of Chief Justice D K Upadhyaya and Justice Tejas Karia also constituted a monitoring committee to supervise rehabilitation of the dwellers and said authorities would “strictly” honour their undertakings and the court’s June 4 direc-



Residents outside the AICC headquarters to seeking intervention of Rahul Gandhi, in New Delhi PTI

DELHI HC ON TUESDAY GRANTED THESE RESIDENTS SIX WEEKS TO VACATE THEIR HOMES AND RELOCATE TO ALTERNATIVE ACCOMMODATION AT SAVDA GHEVRA

tions to ensure amenities, like schools, electricity, LPG connection, bus passes, dispensaries, etc., to them at Savda Ghevra.

The Centre had sought their eviction on the grounds that the jhuggi-jhopdi clusters were in a protected zone, immediately next to an operational Air Force Station, and the decision to remove unauthorised construction in the area was taken to strengthen and secure defence infrastructure and for other important public and security purposes.

UP polls: Yogi’s selfie moments signal softer outreach

BISWAJEET BANERJEE Lucknow August 29



Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, known for his tough administrative style and strong law-and-order image, has in recent days been seen in a rather different role.

From posing with Japanese students and newly appointed government employees to joining women in a state bus and clicking photographs with schoolgirls on Raksha Bandhan, the chief minister appears to be adding a more informal touch to his public outreach.

The series of selfies over the past week has attracted attention as UPheads towards the 2027 Assembly elections, when the BJP will be looking to consolidate its support among young voters and women. The latest interaction took place on Friday when schoolgirls visited the chief minister’s residence to tie rakhis on Raksha Bandhan.

Adityanath posed for photographs with the children and asked them, “Bachcho idhar dekho”, as they gathered for the picture.

The moment was different from the CM’s usual public appearances, where he is generally seen addressing large gatherings, reviewing government programmes or interacting with officials.

Kolkata looks to shape new chapter in India-Russia ties

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE Kolkata, August 29

With the advent of a new era in the India-Russia relationship, against the backdrop of a more dynamic and volatile international landscape, the eastern Indian city of Kolkata is poised to establish itself as an important player in the evolving strategic discourse between the two countries.

The SAMPARK - India-Russia Bilateral Conclave 2026, which will take place in Kolkata on August 31, Monday, aims to put the Eastern part of the coun-

try in the spotlight by providing an important forum to deliberate on possible avenues for strategic cooperation between New Delhi and Moscow in areas like trade, technology and culture.

What makes the initiative important is not just the wide array of topics suggested for discussion, but also the effort to expand the geographical dimensions of the India-Russia relationship. Most of the strategic discourse about the bilateral relationship has always taken place within the context of the nation’s capital and the

HIGHLIGHTS

- » What makes the initiative important is not just the wide array of topics suggested for discussion, but also the effort to expand the geographical dimensions of the India-Russia relationship
- » The historical position of the city as a link between India and Russia provides an interesting backdrop for this programme

institutions based there.

Through SAMPARK, the idea is to give West Bengal and the wider Eastern Corridor a chance to contribute to the discussions about trade, connectivity, energy and culture.

The historical position of the city as a link between

India and Russia provides an interesting backdrop for this programme.

The discussions will examine how the geographical positioning, industrial and institutional strengths of the region could provide new avenues for fruitful col-

laboration among the two nations. This programme will also seek to emphasise the increasing importance of sub-national organisations and regional economic centres in international diplomacy.

This one-day programme is organised by the Kolkata-based strategic think tank P3 (People. Policy. Polity.). The debates are to be held under the broad theme areas of culture, strategic trade and investments, energy dynamics, and technology and strategic emerging sectors. This agenda covers a wide

variety of sectors such as MSMEs, textiles, tea and agriculture, manufacturing, conventional and sustainable energy, and digital technology and artificial intelligence.

This selection of sectors indicates an attempt to go beyond the traditional foundations of the India-Russia relationship into areas that could see a greater role for commercial relations and technological cooperation.

There is an intention here to supplement diplomatic relations through business and government-to-government linkages.

WOMEN'S ASIA CUP T20

Consistency and form in spotlight as team India takes on Thailand

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Dubai, August 29

Harmanpreet Kaur's India will look to banish their ordinary run in the shortest format while facing questions over their consistency and form as they take on Thailand in their Women's T20 Asia Cup Group A opener here on Sunday. India have been the most dominant team in the Women's T20 Asia Cup over the last decade -- winning the title thrice in five editions of the T20 format since 2016-17 -- but their performances bring forth more concerns than assurances at the moment.

India have lost nine of 16 T20Is this year, and their most recent loss -- against Australia in the Women's T20 World Cup -- knocked them out of the competition at the group stage itself.

With questions persisting over captain Harmanpreet's own form and future in the shortest format, India head into a crucial phase of competing in two Asian-level competitions in which they would be expected to go the distance. Follow-



INDIA HAVE BEEN THE MOST DOMINANT TEAM IN THE WOMEN'S T20 ASIA CUP OVER THE LAST DECADE -- WINNING THE TITLE THRICE IN FIVE EDITIONS OF THE T20 FORMAT SINCE 2016-17

ing the eight-team Women's T20 Asia Cup, where India are placed in Group A along with Thailand, Hong Kong and Pakistan, they will head into next month's Asian Games in Japan with expectations high to bring more laurels to the country. Having endured a largely disappointing campaign in the Women's T20 World Cup, Harmanpreet fired in the all-important clash against Australia, but her inconsistency with the bat remained one of the talking

points from the campaign in which India struggled against higher-ranked teams. With dependable batter Jemimah Rodrigues sidelined for the Asia Cup and Asian Games, India have added Pratika Rawal to their star-studded squad, but the choice hardly settles the requirement for a middle-order enforcer. At the top, India will continue to have the formidable opening pair of

KEY POINTS

- » India have lost nine of 16 T20Is this year, and their most recent loss -- against Australia in the Women's T20 World Cup -- knocked them out of the competition at the group stage itself
- » In the eight-team Women's T20 Asia Cup, where India are placed in Group A along with Thailand, Hong Kong and Pakistan
- » They will head into next month's Asian Games in Japan with expectations high to bring more laurels to the country

Smriti Mandhana and Shafali Verma, but the biggest challenge for batters at No. 3 and beyond would be to sustain momentum and provide further impetus to the scoreboard. India will rely on their seasoned all-rounder Deepti Sharma to lead the spin attack once again, with Shree Charani, the highest wicket-taker of the T20 World Cup, Radha Yadav and Prema Rawat sharing the workload. India's seam bowl-

ing arsenal looks potent too, with the experienced Renuka Singh Thakur having the likes of Kranti Gaud, Arundhati Reddy and Nandani Sharma to share the responsibilities.

Thailand, meanwhile, will look to draw confidence from their victory over Hong Kong in their opening match, for which they had to work hard. Teams (from):

India: Harmanpreet Kaur (c), Smriti Mandhana (vc), Bharti Fulmali, Richa Ghosh (wk), Gunalan Kamalini (wk), Pratika Rawal, Shafali Verma, Deepti Sharma, Kranti Gaud, Prema Rawat, Arundhati Reddy, Renuka Singh Thakur, Nandani Sharma, Shree Charani, Radha Yadav.

Thailand: Naruemol Chaiwai (c), Nannaphat Chaihan, Natthakan Chantham, Naomi Hilton, Nannapat Koncharoenkai (wk), Onnichia Kamchomphu, Phannitha Maya, Chanida Suthiruang, Aphisara Suwanchorathi, Sunida Chaturongrattana, Chayanisa Phengpaen, Suleeporn Laomi, Thipatcha Putthawong, Thanrada Seesawan, Koranit Suwanchonrathi.

WOMEN'S HOCKEY WC

Argentina beat Netherlands 3-1 in shoot-out to claim third title

AGENCIES
Amstelveen, August 29

Argentina snapped co-host the Netherlands' dream run of four consecutive women's FIH World Cup titles by winning the crown, defeating the Dutch side 3-1 in penalty shoot-out after both the teams were locked 1-1 at end of the regulation time here on Saturday. Argentina, thus, avenged their last World Cup and Tokyo Olympics final defeat to win their third title.

The first goal was scored in the 30th minute by Netherlands Yibbi Jansen, considered the world's number one drag-flicker. Argentina received eight penalty corners in the match, and captain Maria Granatto converted the eighth penalty corner to equalise on a rebound in the 54th minute, forcing the match into a penalty shootout.

In the shootout Marjin Veen scored for the Netherlands while Pien Sanders and Felice Albers missed.

For Argentina Victoria Granatto, Brisa Bruggesser and Sofia Cairo scored while Zoe Diaz's goal was disallowed on referral. Earlier, Argentina had won the

EARLIER, ARGENTINA HAD WON THE TITLE BY DEFEATING THE NETHERLANDS IN 2002 AND 2010

title by defeating the Netherlands in 2002 and 2010. In the last World Cup final in 2022, the Dutch prevailed 3-1. These teams also played the gold medal match at the Tokyo Olympics, with the Netherlands winning with the exact same scoreline.

The nine-time champion the Netherlands came through a dramatic battle against Belgium surviving a late disallowed goal to win the semifinal by merely one goal. The second semifinal was similarly close with Argentina defeating Australia with the same margin. Earlier, Belgium finished third defeating Australia by 1-0 in a hard fought third place play-off match. The first 15 minutes were evenly contested, with both teams testing each other.

The Netherlands launched their first attack in the eighth minute when Marleen Jochems delivered the ball into the circle, but no one was there to inter-

cept it. Two minutes later, Sanders entered the circle again, but the Argentine defenders cleared the ball safely. Argentina's Miranda Victoria attempted to break through the Dutch defence in the 13th minute but could not succeed.

Dutch forward Pien Dicke failed to finish a good move into a counterattack.

The Netherlands took the lead just before half-time when Jansen converted their first penalty corner with a powerful drag flick.

Argentina struggled to capitalise on their chances after the break, with goalkeeper Anne Veenendaal making crucial saves, including from Gorzelany's drag flick.

Argentina missed several penalty corners and squandered a clear chance to equalise when Granato lost control inside the D.

The Netherlands earned their third penalty corner in the 50th minute, but Malta's effort went wide.

Argentina eventually levelled from their eighth penalty corner after Veenendaal slipped while attempting to stop Gorzelany's flick, allowing captain Granatto to score from the rebound.

Ankle injury: Neeraj Chopra out of Asian Games, 2026 season

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 29

In a setback for India's athletics campaign at the Asian Games, Olympic champion Neeraj Chopra on Saturday announced that he will miss the remainder of the

2026 season, including the Continental showpiece in Japan, after suffering a ligament tear in his ankle during training.

Chopra said he sustained the injury shortly after producing a season-best throw at the Lausanne



Diamond League. "After a period of hard work, I

finally felt I was gaining the momentum I had been looking for with a season's best throw in Lausanne.

"Unfortunately, shortly after, I sustained a ligament tear in my ankle during training. After discussions with my doctor and team, we've decided that I will sit out the rest of this season," Chopra said in a post on Instagram.

The 28-year-old javelin thrower said the decision was disappointing as he felt he was "close to finding my rhythm", but added that his immediate focus would be on recovery. "My focus now is on recovering well and coming back even stronger," he said.

While his focus now shifts towards rehabilitation, the athlete has made it clear that he intends to return to competition after recovering

fully from the injury.

"It's disappointing, especially because I felt close to finding my rhythm. But as they say, setbacks are a part of the journey," he said. "Thank you all for the love and support," Chopra added.

The injury means he will also miss the Diamond League Finals in Brussels on September 5 though he had qualified for it.

Chopra's withdrawal is a major setback for India at the Asian Games, where he was expected to be one of the country's biggest medal hopes.

The Tokyo Olympics gold medalist had endured a challenging phase in the build-up to the second half of the season, but his performance in Lausanne had offered encouragement that he was finding his rhythm again.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Kamal** S/o Lt. Omprakash, R/o 264, Chandra Sekhar Gali Babarpur, Jafrabad, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 314/19 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Gokalpuri, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Kamal** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Kamal** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Kamal** in **FIR No. 314/19 U/s 33/58 Delhi Excise ACT, PS Gokalpuri, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No. 22
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12109/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Sunil Kumar S/o Muniya Kumar R/o H. No. C-37, Aram Bagh, Paharganj, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 206/2020 U/S 324/34 IPC, PS Paharganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Sunil Kumar** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Sunil Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Sunil Kumar** of **FIR No. 206/2020 U/S 324/34 IPC, PS Paharganj, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **03.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Neetu Sharma
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate-01
Central District, Room No. 366
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/12152/CD/2026(Court Matter)

Velavan Senthilkumar wins Budapest Open squash



PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Budapest, August 29

India's Velavan Senthilkumar won his maiden PSA Copper-level crown at the Budapest Open squash in the Hungarian capital, defeating Balazs Farkas in the summit clash.

The world No. 54 and eighth-seeded Indian player beat the local favourite Farkas 11-4, 11-2, 11-3 in the final of the USD 43,500 prize money tournament for his 11th PSA Tour crown.

It was also their third meeting on the Tour, with Senthilkumar winning their previous meeting in 2024.

Senthilkumar had beaten compatriot Veer Chotrani (9-11, 11-8, 11-7, 1-11, 12-10) in the semifinal.

The Indian had defeated Malaysia's world No. 19 Eain Yow in the quarterfinals.

Suryakumar Yadav was shocked over T20I captaincy sacking

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
New Delhi, August 29

Former T20I captain Suryakumar Yadav has opened up about the shock and disappointment he felt after being removed from captaincy despite guiding India to the T20 World Cup title at home.

Suryakumar was subsequently left out of India's T20I squad for the United Kingdom tour, which featured matches against Ireland and England. Shreyas Iyer was appointed the new T20I captain following his successful stint with Punjab Kings in the IPL.

Suryakumar said he spent nearly two months struggling to understand what had happened.

"I sat at home for 40-50 days. I was doing nothing, and I was completely shocked. I was thinking, what should I do now? Do I want to play or not?" he told former India cricketer Aakash Chopra on his YouTube channel.

"A lot was going on in my mind. One day, suddenly my wife said, 'Just think about why you started playing this game 20 years ago? Because you were mad for this game. Then bring that passion back again.'"

The 35-year-old Mumbai batter has established himself as one of India's



leading T20I run-scorers, accumulating 3,272 runs in 113 matches at a strike rate of 162.94 and an average of 36.35. His international record includes four centuries, 25 fifties and a highest score of 117.

However, his numbers have dipped since India's 2024 T20 World Cup triumph. In his following 42 innings, Suryakumar has scored 932 runs at an average of 25.88, with only six half-centuries.

Despite the setbacks, Suryakumar said he deliberately chose not to react emotionally when his name was missing from the squad.

"I smiled like this when my name was not there. Whatever cricket I played throughout the two years, whenever I was in situations where there was pressure and things were not going my way, I have always smiled," he said.

Suryakumar admitted that being removed from the leadership role was something he had never anticipated.

झारखण्ड सरकार

कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय,ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा

ई-पुनर्निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई-पुनर्निविदा संख्या- 09/RI/2026-27/RWD/CHATRA दिनांक- 27.08.2026
कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा द्वारा निम्न विवरण के अनुसार e-procurement पद्धति से निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है।

क्र. सं.	आईडेंटिफिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या	कार्य का नाम	प्राकलित राशि		कार्य समाप्ति की अवधि	टेंडर कॉल सं.
			अंक में (लाख)	अक्षर में		
1	RWD/CHATRA/39/2024-25	ग्राम-सुईयाटांड में राहम-बड़गांव पथ गोन्दा स्कूल से सुईयाटांड तक पथ निर्माण कार्य (लं.-2.500 कि.मी.)।	294.043	दो कराड़ चौरानवे लाख चार हजार तीन सौ मात्र	15 माह	द्वितीय

- वेबसाईट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि :- 01.09.2026
- ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की अंतिम तिथि एवं समय :- 21.09.2026 अपराह्न 5.00 बजे तक।
- ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय :- 24.09.2026 पूर्वाह्न 11.00 बजे।
- ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करनेवाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियन्ता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग, कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा, द्वितीय तल, विकास भवन, चतरा।
- ई-निविदा प्रकोष्ठ का दूरभाष संख्या :- 06541-296208
- विस्तृत जानकारी के लिए वेबसाईट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in में देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण कार्य विभाग,कार्य प्रमण्डल, चतरा।
PR 388585 (Rural Work Department)26-27*D

JHARIA REHABILITATION AND DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY, DHANBAD

e-Procurement Notice

Tender Reference No: JRDA/CIVIL/26-27/22/238

Date: 29.08.2026

1.	Name of Work	Construction of Shopping Center including 80 Shops and two halls in different places in Belgaria, Dhanbad (2nd Call).
2.	Estimated Cost	Rs. 4,96,69,628.00
3.	EMD	Rs. 4,96,700.00
4.	Tender Document Cost	Rs. 10,000.00
5.	Time of Completion	11 months
6.	Date/Time from which bid is available for online bidding	02.09.2026 at 03:00 PM
7.	Last Date/Time for on-line submission of bids	23.09.2026 at 5:00 PM
8.	Date and Time of Bid Opening	25.09.2026 at 11:30 AM
9.	Name and Address of Officer inviting tender	Head of Department (Civil), JRDA, Dhanbad Hatia More, Golf Ground Road, Hirapur, Dhanbad - 826001 Jharkhand, India Email: infojrda.dhn@gmail.com

Note: 1. Only e-tenders will be accepted.

2. Further details can be seen on website –https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in

Head of Department (Civil), JRDA, Dhanbad

PR 388613 District (26-27)_D

भारत कोकिंग कोयला लिमिटेड

BCCL

भारत कोकिंग कोयला लिमिटेड

BHARAT COKING COAL LIMITED

(A Mini Ratna Company)

(A subsidiary of Coal India Limited)

NOTICE

All the tenders issued by Bharat Coking Coal Limited (BCCL) for procurement of Goods, Works and Services are available on website of BCCL "www.bccclweb.in" Coal India Limited (CIL) e-procurement portal "https://coaliindiattenders.nic.in" and Central Public Procurement Portal "https://eprocure.gov.in". In addition, procurement is also done through GeM portal "https://gem.gov.in".

This is applicable to all Open (Domestic / Global) Tenders issued through e-procurement portal of CIL.

This information is also available on BCCL Website www.bccclweb.in

SOUTHERN RAILWAY

Salem Division

Office of the Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer, Electric Loco Shed, Erode

E-Tender Notice

Online tender is invited for the following work:

Tender No	Description of Work
SA_A_RS_ED_OT_26_27_12, Dt.27-08-2026	Work Contract for Shifting of CAB AC control panel and switch panel along with cables from cab desk bottom to corridor door inside in both cab of Electric locomotive available at Electric Loco Shed, Southern Railway, Salem Division, Erode.
SA_A_RS_ED_OT_26_27_13, Dt.27-08-2026	Contract for machining of equipment and provision of forklift operator at Electric Loco Shed, Southern Railway, Salem Division, Erode.

All details regarding the tender are available at https://www.ireps.gov.in

DEE/RS/ED
For Sr.DEE/RS/ED

जम्मू और कश्मीर पुलिस

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Lal Hussain alias Kuka S/O Mir Mohd Caste Muslim R/O Salatir Poonch (Driver Matadorea bearing registration JK02A-1821 is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 144/1991 U/S 279/337 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Lal Hussain alias Kuka
S/O : Mir Mohd
Caste : Muslim
Address : Salatir Poonch
A/P : M.Door 8745/HP.11A
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 0191 2433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133
Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-8971/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Suraj Kumar S/o Manoj Kumar R/o** H.No. A-151, 2nd Floor, Camp No. 4, Jwalapuri, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 561/2019 U/s 356/379 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Suraj Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Suraj Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Suraj Kumar** of under **FIR No. 561/2019 U/s 356/379 IPC.**, Registered at **PS: Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ankit Karan Singh
MM-08 (West), Room No. 30
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12210/OD/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 CrPC

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Rahul Chauhan S/o Sh. Rakesh Chauhan & Dilip Chauhan S/o Sh. Rakesh Chauhan** both **R/o B-396, Gali No.2, Bhagya Vihar, Rani Khara, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case registered vide **FIR No. 669/2015 U/S 323/354A/354B/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest their upon issued that the said accused **Rahul Chauhan & Dilip Chauhan** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Rahul Chauhan & Dilip Chauhan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Rahul Chauhan & Dilip Chauhan** of **FIR No. 669/2015 U/S 323/354A/354B/34 IPC, PS Aman Vihar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court (or before me) to answer the complaint on or before the day of **17.10.2026**.

By Order,
Ms. Neha Goel
Metropolitan Magistrate, Mahila Court-02,
North West, Room No.18, Ground Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/11759/RD/2026(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Salman, S/o: Lt. Md. Naem, R/o: H.No. 1/1 Near Brijpuri Puliya, Ziauddinpur, New Mustafabad, North East Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 314/2026, Dt. 06.04.26, U/s: 112(2)/317(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Salman**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Salman**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Salman**, of **FIR No. 314/2026, Dt. 06.04.26, U/s: 112(2)/317(5) Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita-2023, PS: Sadar Bazar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **30.09.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Kartik Taparia
Judicial Magistrate First Class-06
Central District Room No. 247
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12220/N/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Mr. Yellanki Pochalu M/s Annapoorna Fertilizers Pesticides and Seeds Also At: 5-56, Main Road, Village Kanagarthi, Distt. Peddapalli, Telangana** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC NI Act 1720/2021 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Anand Parbat, Delhi**, and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mr. Yellanki Pochalu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mr. Yellanki Pochalu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mr. Yellanki Pochalu** accused of **CC NI Act 1720/2021 U/s 138 NI Act PS: Anand Parbat, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **21.11.2026**.

By Order
JMFC-06, (West)
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12173/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

प्रथम तल, कॉन्फ्रेंसिंग कॉम्प्लेक्स, ओम्नेगा-1 (पी-2), ग्रेटर नोएडा

Toll Free No. 18001808298 वेबसाइट - www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

Reference Number: YEA/GM(P)/2026/571

Dated: 27.08.2026

Request for Proposal (RFP) For Field quality assurance & auditing work for project works of Yamuna Expressway Industrial Development Authority

Detailed RFP document is available on the E-Procurement Portal of Government of UP [http://etender.up.nic.in] from 03/09/2026

Interested Bidders are required to apply online on the E-procurement website on or before 17/09/2026, 17:00 hrs (IST). In case of any queries, the Bidders are invited to contact GM (Project), YEIDA.

Email: gmproj@yamunaexpresswayauthority.com

GM, Project, YEIDA

यमुना एक्सप्रेसवे औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण के अधिसूचित क्षेत्र में प्राधिकरण द्वारा स्वीकृत मास्टर प्लान के अतिरिक्त प्लॉटिंग/हाउसिंग/कॉलोनी या किसी भी प्रकार का अन्य निर्माण पूरी तरह से अवैध है। सामान्यजन इस प्रकार की खरीद-फरोख्त से पूर्णतः सचेत रहें तथा कॉलोनीइज के ग्रामक विज्ञापनों से बचें। अधिक जानकारी के लिए प्राधिकरण की वेबसाइट www.yamunaexpresswayauthority.com देखें।

SYMBOLIC POSSESSION NOTICE

ICI Home Finance

Registered Office: ICICI Bank Towers, Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai-400051

Corporate Office: ICICI HFC Tower, JB Nagar, Andheri Kurla Road, Andheri East, Mumbai- 400059

Branch Office: 1st Floor, 36, Defence enclave, Vikas marg, East Delhi - 110092

Whereas

The undersigned being the Authorized Officer of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) rules 2002, issued demand notices upon the borrowers mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.

As the borrower failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/ her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general is hereby cautioned not to deal with the property and any dealings with the property will be subject to the charge of ICICI Home Finance Company Limited.

The Borrower's attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower/ Co-Borrower/ Loan Account Number	Description of property/ Date of Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs.)	Name of Branch
1.	Sandeep (Borrower), Renuka Soni (Co-Borrower), 16148 FF Gali No 3 Near Mandir East Rohtash Nagar Nor, Babarpur North East Delhi, Flat, Babarpur North East Delhi, Delhi 110032 Delhi, LHLDX00001656452	Ground Floor and First Floor (Without Roof/Terrace Rights, Rights upto Ceiling Level Only), Property No. 1/9147- E(West), out of Khassa No. 399, 604, 397, 398, 400, 501/395, Situated At Village of Uldhanpur In The Abadi of West Rohtas Nagar, Illoaga Shahdra, Delhi-110032, Covered Area on Ground Floor 83.61 Sq. Mtrs And Covered Area on First Floor 83.61 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By: North By: other Property, South By: Other Property, East By: other Property, West By: Road 16 Feet/ Date of Possession 25-Aug-26	14-05-2026 Rs. 29,70,554.6/-	East Delhi- Laxmi Nagar
2.	Sandeep (Borrower), Renuka Soni (Co-Borrower), 16148 FF Gali No 3 Near Mandir East Rohtash Nagar Nor, Babarpur North East Delhi, Flat, Babarpur North East Delhi, Delhi 110032 Delhi, LHLDX00001656500	Ground Floor And First Floor (Without Roof/Terrace Rights, Rights upto Ceiling Level only), Property No. 1/9147- E(West), out of Khassa No. 399, 604, 397, 398, 400, 501/395, Situated At Village of Uldhanpur In The Abadi of West Rohtas Nagar, Illoaga Shahdra, Delhi-110032, Covered Area on Ground Floor 83.61 Sq. Mtrs And Covered Area on First Floor 83.61 Sq. Mtrs. Bounded By: North By: other Property, South By: Other Property, East By: other Property, West By: Road 16 Feet/ Date of Possession 25-Aug-26	14-05-2026 Rs. 66,902/-	East Delhi- Laxmi Nagar

The above-mentioned borrowers(s)/ guarantors(s) are hereby given a 30 day notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold on the expiry of 30 days from the date of publication of this Notice, as per the provisions under the Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: August 30, 2026
Place: Delhi

Authorized Office,
ICICI Home Finance Company Limited

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

SEE SECTION 84 BHARTIYA NAGARIK SURKSHA SANHITA

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Laxman @ Pradhan S/o** Kishan Mistri **R/o** H.No. H-60, Gali No. 05, Zero Pusta, Shastri Park, Delhi have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 514/2022 U/s 380/411 IPC.**, has been registered at **PS: Shastri Park, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Laxman @ Pradhan** namely cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Laxman @ Pradhan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Laxman @ Pradhan** of under **FIR No. 514/2022 U/s 380/411 IPC.**, Registered at **PS: Shastri Park, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **01.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Shruti Saraswat
JMFC-03, Room No. 22, 1st Floor
(NE Distt.), Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/10304/NE/2026
(Court Notice)

जम्मू और कश्मीर पुलिस

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),

email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice

Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Faiz Ahmed S/O Samail Sheikh R/O Dal Gote (Hall) A/P Railway Road, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 65/1993 U/S 457/380 RPC of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Faiz Ahmed
S/O : Samail Sheikh
Address : Dal Gote (Hall) A/P Railway Road, Jammu
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1.DPO, Jammu :0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3.PCR Jammu :0191-2605949
4.SP City South : 0191-2430002
5.SDPO City East : 0191 2433778
6.P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133
Sd/-
Superintendent of Police
Jammu
DIP No:DIP/J-8965/26

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused persons, **Sameer@Rahul, R/o** H.No. 122, 4th Floor, Gali No. 5, Ambedkar Basti Maujpur, Delhi, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. : 80123960/2025, U/s: 303(2), 317(2), 3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita**, registered at **P.S.: IP Estate, Delhi**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Sameer@Rahul**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Sameer@Rahul**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person, **Sameer@Rahul, FIR No. : 80123960/2025, U/s: 303(2), 317(2), 3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita**, registered at **P.S.: IP Estate, Delhi**, are required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Preeti
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 (Central)
Central District. Room No-150,
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/12073/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ravi @ Kitti S/o Rajkumar R/o Jhuggi No. F-7/W-48/147, Sultanpuri, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.499/2017, u/s 307/34 IPC & 25/27/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Subhash Place, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Ravi @ Kitti** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Ravi @ Kitti** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ravi @ Kitti** of **FIR No.499/2017, u/s 307/34 IPC & 25/27/54/59 Arms Act, P.S. Subhash Place, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Muneesh Garg
Additional Session Judge-03
(North-West), Room No. 304, Third Floor
District Courts Rohini, Delhi

DP/12131/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person **Taharik, S/o: Mubarik Ali, R/o: PS: Bahjoi Village Pathakpur Distt. Sambhal UP** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 337/10, U/s: 411/IPC, PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Taharik**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Taharik**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person **Taharik**, of **FIR No. 337/10, U/s: 411/IPC, PS: Rani Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **09.10.2026**.

By Order
Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
North West Court No. 101 First Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/11686/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS!

IMPORTANT NOTICE

EXTENSION OF PERIODICITY OF SPECIAL TRAINS

This is notified for the information of Rail Passengers that Railways have decided to extend the run of following Special Trains. The details are as under :-

Train No.	STATION		Frequency/ Days of Run	Earlier Notified Upto	Extended Upto		Trips
	From	To			From	To	
04123	Prayagraj Jn.	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Wednesday & Sunday	30.08.26	02.09.26	29.11.26	26
04124	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Prayagraj Jn.	Thursday & Monday	31.08.26	03.09.26	30.11.26	26
09309	Indore Jn.	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Friday & Sunday	30.08.26	04.09.26	27.11.26	25
09310	Hazrat Nizamuddin	Indore Jn.	Monday & Saturday	31.08.26	05.09.26	28.11.26	25
09257	Bhavnagar Terminus	Shakur Basti	Friday	31.07.26	16.10.26	27.11.26	07
09258	Shakur Basti	Bhavnagar Terminus	Saturday	01.08.26	17.10.26	28.11.26	07
09195	Pratapnagar (via VARANASI)	Mau Jn.	Saturday	26.09.26	03.10.26	28.11.26	09
09196	Mau Jn.	Pratapnagar	Sunday	27.09.26	04.10.26	29.11.26	09
09203	Veraval Jn.	Haridwar	Tuesday	28.07.26	20.10.26	24.11.26	06
09204	Haridwar	Veraval Jn.	Wednesday	29.07.26	21.10.26	25.11.26	06
09065	Surat	Chhapra Jn.	Tuesday	29.09.26	06.10.26	24.11.26	08
09066	Chhapra Jn.	Surat	Wednesay	30.09.26	07.10.26	25.11.26	08
09451	Gandhidham Jn.	Bhagalpur Jn.	Friday	28.08.26	04.09.26	27.11.26	13
09452	Bhagalpur Jn.	Gandhidham Jn.	Monday	31.08.26	07.09.26	30.11.26	13
09523	Okha	Shakur Basti	Tuesday	28.07.26	20.10.26	24.11.26	06
09524	Shakur Basti	Okha	Wednesday	29.07.26	21.10.26	25.11.26	06
09425	Sabarmati	Haridwar	Monday	27.07.26	19.10.26	23.11.26	06
09426	Haridwar	Sabarmati	Tuesday	28.07.26	20.10.26	24.11.26	06
04811	Barmer	Haridwar	Mon, Thu	27.08.26	31.08.26	30.11.26	27
04812	Haridwar	Barmer	Tue, Fri	28.08.26	01.09.26	01.12.26	27
09611	Ajmer Jn.	Yog Nagari Rishikesh	Wednesday	30.09.26	14.10.26	25.11.26	07
09612	Yog Nagari Rishikesh	Ajmer Jn.	Thursday	01.10.26	15.10.26	26.11.26	07
09639	Madar Jn.	Rohtak Jn.	Daily	15.07.26	14.10.26	30.11.26	48
09640	Rohtak Jn.	Madar Jn.	Daily	15.07.26	14.10.26	30.11.26	48

For any kind of information such as arrival/departure timings and stoppages enroute etc., passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in or NTES App.

RailMadad Helpline No. 139

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SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

29865/2026

Color calibration bars and registration marks.

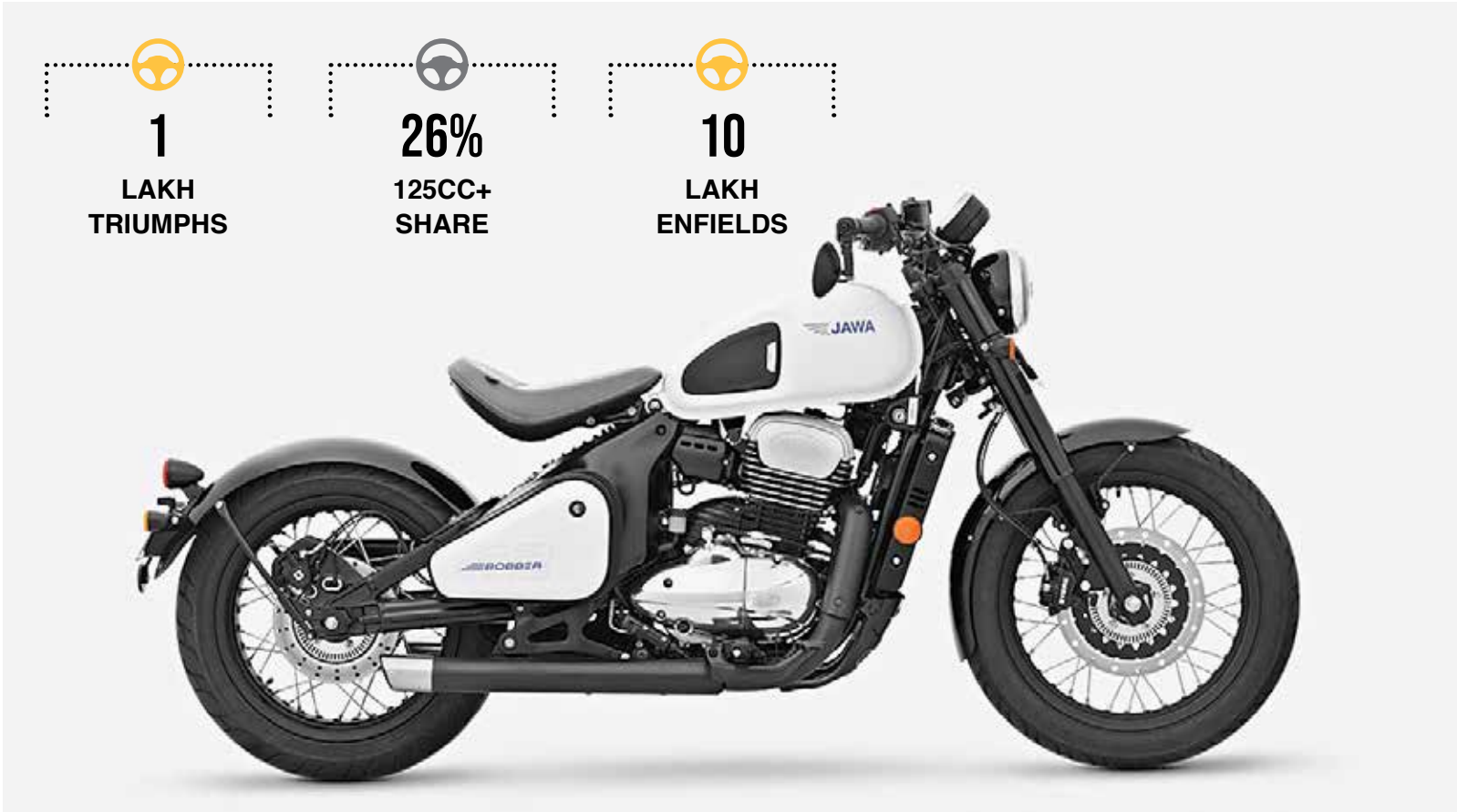


The Price of Playing God

Perhaps that is the real price of playing God. Not that nature will punish us. Nature does not have to. It simply keeps behaving according to its own rules. The choice before us is whether we will finally learn to build within them.

But disasters are often created by the combination of a natural hazard and human vulnerability. That distinction matters. A flood becomes a catastrophe when people, homes and infrastructure occupy places where floodwater must go. A landslide becomes a tragedy when roads and settlements are placed beneath





RETRO WITHOUT REGRET

Young India is falling for motorcycles that look reassuringly old, ride decidedly new and prove that nostalgia needs no first-hand memories. Old is again gold



player, an Ambassador or your father's old Yezdi. But what is a 24-year-old nostalgic about when he looks at a motorcycle styled after one built decades before he was born? Perhaps nostalgia is no longer a prerequisite for retro.

Old. Not Really

Scratch the surface and these motorcycles are about as old-fashioned as Instagram. Today's rider may admire a finned cylinder head, but he doesn't want it to overheat. Carburettors have charm until the bike refuses to start in the morning. Drum brakes are authentic until the autorickshaw ahead slams on its brakes. And an oil leak is more romantic when it belongs to somebody else's vintage motorcycle. Modern retro is clever. It sells the emotion of old machinery without demanding the sacrifice.

Triumph describes the Speed 400 as blending a classic engine profile and traditional design details with modern engineering. Beneath the old-school visual cues are liquid cooling, fuel injection, ride-by-wire, traction control and ABS. The story is similar across the chain: yesterday outside, tomorrow underneath. Young India, it seems, wants the past. It just wants the past to start every morning.

Changing Gears

There is a bigger shift underneath the styling. For generations, India's motorcycle was an instrument of mobility. Period. It carried people to offices, factories, colleges and markets. The questions at the showroom were sensible ones: Kitna deti hai? What will servicing cost? Will the family fit? Those questions haven't disappeared. But another one has joined them: Do I actually want this motorcycle?

India's motorcycle

market is moving up the aspiration ladder. Bikes of 125cc and above accounted for 26 per cent of sales in the first 10 months of FY 2025-26, compared with 22.1 per cent in FY 2019-20. The shift reflects rising aspirations, improving affordability and a premiumisation of the Indian motorcycle market.

Royal Enfield offers the best evidence. It crossed 1 million in domestic sales for the first time recently, with its 350cc motorcycles doing most of the heavy lifting. The Classic remains a formidable seller. This is no more a niche tribe of Sunday riders polishing chrome in the suburbs. Retro is mainstream. That is perhaps because the bike itself is changing roles. For a growing section of urban India, it is transport, certainly. But it is also leisure, fashion, identity and therapy with a registration number.



Then you encounter a motorcycle. There is an engine. You can see it. There are exhaust pipes that actually go somewhere. A fuel tank looks like a fuel tank. The rider sits astride the machine rather than inside a cocoon of screens and software. Perhaps the appeal of retro motorcycles is not really about looking backwards. It is about wanting something mechanical in a fast-paced, digital world.

That could also explain why manufacturers are not taking the retro business too literally. Buyers may want analogue-looking dials, but navigation on the phone is welcome. They treasure an old-fashioned exhaust note, but not old-fashioned emissions. They like mechanical purity, provided it arrives with a service network and roadside assistance. They want motorcycles that look as though they require a toolkit, while secretly hoping never to open one.

Future Perfect

For India's bike companies, there is an interesting lesson. The future need not always look futuristic. Electrification, connectivity and sophisticated electronics will inevitably transform two-wheelers. But that doesn't mean every motorcycle must resemble a household appliance from 2040. Motorcycling has always been emotional. Specifications matter, but so do sound, proportion, texture and the silly little ritual of turning around after parking to look at your motorcycle one more time.

India's modern-retro boom suggests younger riders have not lost that instinct. If anything, surrounded by more technology than any generation before them, they may value it more. So, let the engines get cleaner. Let the electronics get smarter. Let safety improve and engineering march on relentlessly. Just don't throw away the round headlamp. After all, the hottest new idea in Indian motorcycling may turn out to be making tomorrow work beautifully while ensuring it still looks a little like yesterday.



Machine Appeal

There may be another reason retro is working. Look at modern life. The TV is a black rectangle. The phone is a rectangle. The laptop is another rectangle. The car dashboard is becoming a collection of rectangles.

Products are getting technologically smarter while becoming visually harder to distinguish.



Wellness

Beyond Bad Behaviour



Childhood aggression may reflect trauma, family instability or emotional difficulties, requiring timely professional attention and care

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

“Doctor, my 10-year-old has become someone I don't recognise. He punched a classmate so badly that the child needed medical attention. He is stealing money from my bag. His teachers call me every week. His father was never really present, and there was a lot of violence at home for years. I keep asking myself, where did I go wrong?”

That last question is the one I hear most often from parents in this situation. And I want to redirect it gently. The more useful question is not, where did I go wrong? It is, what is my child's behaviour trying to tell us?

Not every difficult child has a psychiatric disorder. Children argue, test limits, and occasionally lie. That is development. But when aggression, deceit and rule-breaking become repetitive and severe, and begin harming others, it is time to look beyond bad behaviour.

What psychiatrists assess for in this situation

While I cannot diagnose your child without examining them, one condition we consider is Conduct Disorder. It is not stubbornness or naughtiness. It is a persistent pattern of violating the rights of others or breaking age-appropriate social norms. Repeated bullying, physical fights, deliberate destruction of property, stealing, lying, and notably little remorse after hurting someone. Not isolated incidents. A pattern that disrupts school, family and relationships over time.

Parents often confuse this with Oppositional Defiant Disorder. A child with ODD argues, refuses instructions, loses their temper and challenges authority. A child with Conduct Disorder goes a step further by repeatedly causing significant harm to people, animals or property. The distinction matters clinically because the intervention differs.

Why it happens

There is rarely a single cause. Genetics, temperament, trauma, exposure to domestic violence, inconsistent discipline, learning difficulties, bullying and stressful family environments all contribute. In many children, aggressive behaviour is less about wanting to hurt others and more about never having learned healthy ways to regulate anger, frustration or fear.

In your son's case, the history of domestic violence and an absent father are not

background details. They are clinically significant. Children who grow up witnessing violence often carry emotional wounds they cannot put into words. Sometimes those wounds come out as fists.

What does not work

Punishment alone. Parents understandably respond by becoming harsher, hoping stricter discipline will teach a lesson. Repeated shouting, humiliation or physical punishment more often reinforces the very behaviour it is trying to stop. The child learns that aggression is how adults respond to problems. He already knew that.

What actually helps

Start with structure. Clear, consistent rules with predictable consequences, not expectations that shift depending on the day.

Catch and acknowledge positive behaviour, however small, rather than only responding when things go wrong.

Know his friends, his online activity, his school environment. Children with conduct difficulties are particularly vulnerable to

SOMETIMES EMOTIONAL WOUNDS CHILDREN CANNOT ARTICULATE EMERGE THROUGH THEIR FISTS

negative peer influence. Seek professional help early and specifically.

Parent management training, behavioural therapy and family therapy have strong evidence behind them.

Your son also needs assessment for coexisting conditions, including ADHD, depression, anxiety and learning disorders, all of which commonly accompany conduct difficulties and significantly worsen them when unaddressed.

What you need to remember as a parent

A child who lies, steals or becomes aggressive is not automatically destined for a troubled future. The trajectory is not fixed. Early, structured intervention changes outcomes significantly. The research is consistent on this. You did not create this alone. And you cannot reverse it alone either. As psychiatrists, we do not only ask, why is this child behaving this way? We ask, what has this child experienced, and what skills is he missing?

Because behind every difficult behaviour is a child whose story deserves to be understood before it is judged. I've retained the original structure, tone and length rather than rewriting or compressing it.

Everyday Life, Unfiltered

Through humour, nostalgia and sharp observation, *Unfiltered: The Little Things* finds meaning and amusement in the seemingly unremarkable moments of everyday life



AUTHOR



SANJEEV CHOPRA

Filter coffee. Instant coffee. Arabica. Espresso. Flat white. Cappuccino. Americano – all these different types of coffees are available on the menu cards in cafes, airport lounges and specialty restaurants. The basic ingredient, of course, is coffee, but each of these variants has different flavours – or should we say processing – for while much of the essence is preserved, something is also lost in the process of refinement. But raw, unfiltered coffee is also unique in the sense that it is closer to the soil and gives a taste of reality that boutique varieties cannot.

Unfiltered: The Little Things, by Ratna Manucha (RM), is a potpourri of three and thirty articles and eight poems about extraordinary observations of everyday life, each funny, irreverent and very much next-door. The eight poems include “Laughter”, which could be read as a prelude to the book. Then there is a poem to close each of the seven sections: ‘Phone Alone’ (“Changing Times”), ‘City Woes’ (“On My Terms”), ‘Quirky Kinks’ (“Upside Down”), ‘Social Graces’ (“The Visit”), ‘Forever Friends’ (“Life In The Army – Is A Song”),

‘Odds and Ends’ (“A Child in Every Man”) and ‘Covid Capers’, which closes with “Ceaseless Wonders” as an epilogue of sorts.

Most columns in this compilation have appeared in the *Garhwal Post* – the demi-official Gazetteer of Dehradun – for if a milestone has not been reported on its pages, it hasn’t occurred at all. Thus, most of Ratna’s loyal readers in the Valley of Doon have probably read most, if not all, of these articles. However, since this cheerful book and review have an audience well beyond this beautiful city, let me share my thoughts on the entries in this offering.

We begin with the poems. “Laughter” reminds us that wrinkles on the faces of senior citizens are actually laughter lines to be proud of, while “Changing Times” has a lament from an old oak tree whose brothers have all been chopped up and taken away. “A Child in Every Man” tells us that the child present in every person must be encouraged to come out now and then to forget the strife of life. Finally, we have “Ceaseless Wonders”: “The first light at dawn/ The red gold of the sky/ The peaceful gliding of the swans/ And the clouds sailing by.”

We will now take up each section sequentially. ‘Phone Alone’ has six entries on how senior citizens are learning to cope with the ubiquitous cell phone, which has replaced the

‘man’s wallet’ and the ladies’ ‘lacy handkerchief’ as companion status symbols, but with a difference. This device screams for and gets attention, unlike the staid old landline, which sat placidly in the room and often did not ring for hours. The cell phone, however, is hyper even at siesta time. Emojis are the new shorthand, and PayTM is the preferred mode of financial transaction. The little paper phone books of the past now have archival value only for their owners: no more, no less.

In ‘City Woes’, Ratna regrets the loss of the tall eucalyptus trees on Rajpur Road and along the Parade Ground; even the verdant greens of the PBG estate have given way to yet another concrete museum/ auditorium. We have heard of VIPs, but she also talks of PTBs (Powers That Be), who issue inane advisories to ‘keep your city clean’ even as they are responsible for potholes which breed mosquitoes of all shades, shapes and sizes. In “My Countrymen, My Rules”, RM rues the civic habits of fellow citizens who litter under the impression that some divine magic wand will clear the garbage away. While Uttarakhand promotes itself as a wedding destination and offers concessions for film crews, she wonders whether the hills have the carrying capacity to bear this additional load. “Quirky Kinks” is about

oniomaniacs who have a ‘compulsive shopping disorder’. Inspired by recently invented days devoted to Valentines, mothers, teachers, fathers, daughters, sisters, brothers and Best Friends Forever, they shop endlessly and balance the guilt by saying their purchases are ethical, sustainable, recyclable and have low carbon footprints! She then devotes a chapter to how she, as a MANucha-by-marriage, looks at mandarins, manoeuvres, mankind, manifestation, mannequins, mangoes, manicures, manhunts, manuals and maniacs. It appears that the entire vocabulary is loaded in favour of man!

Walking Corpse Syndrome (WCS) is the newest coping mechanism, with an RM copyright, to be used liberally when anyone responds to a how-do-you-do with a litany of complaints from heart issues to sciatica and knee replacements. As this is a new and special kind of problem which only readers of her column know, it leads to the other person scurrying for cover. This opens the fifth section on ‘Social Graces’, which also has a chapter on how prayer meetings end up in inane chatter and potential matchmakers do not even spare young women still in mourning. ‘Passing the Parcel’ is about how gifts for Diwali, birthdays and anniversaries are routinely packed and repacked – but as social circles are nearly the same, there are embarrassing moments when the original gifter gets her own parcel back! Army wives learn the hard

way that regimental colours are never red and yellow, but scarlet and gold, and that the COW (Commanding Officer’s Wife) is not to be questioned, for she knows what is best for the CO and the battalion under his command.

“Friends Forever” is a tribute to all the Rimcolians who assemble year after year for their reunion from 12-14 March and have the incredible capacity to laugh at their own jokes with greater gusto each year. But if Mr Manucha can have all the fun at the Reunion, RM informs us in “A Gal’s Gal Pals” that she has her own friend circles for shopping, coffee, lunches and movies too!

The penultimate section, “Odds and Ends”, has a chapter devoted to Knitfixing – a lexical innovation of the Covid times

– representing knitting while watching content on Netflix. This meant pressing the pause button every two ‘knit rows’ to avoid jumbling up a complicated pattern. Finally, Ratna shares with us in “Covid Capers” the after-effects of staying indoors for too long, suffering from veggie woes and mask mania. But, all in all, despite the challenges and bothers life sends our way, there is “The exquisite beauty of the first snowflake/ The gentleness of the falling snow/ The tranquillity, the beauty and the peace/ Will God’s wonders ever cease?”



Planetary Balance

The Great Ocean Conveyor

PART I

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

Ocean currents quietly redistribute heat across the planet, shaping rainfall, temperatures, marine ecosystems and weather patterns far beyond the seas

We have often heard of the importance of El Niño and La Niña for the Indian monsoons, of the warm Gulf Stream current that warms Europe, and the Labrador Current that brings cold weather to North America. In general, it is well known that ocean currents have determined shipping routes for hundreds of years; it is also known that ocean currents impact climate in various ways, as alluded to above. However, with climate change, the predictability of ocean currents is in question, and their impact can often lead to extreme climate events never seen before. Let us discuss these issues in a three-part article here. In the first part, we will summarise the various ocean currents in the large oceans, and in the second part, we will discuss how climate change is impacting ocean currents and, through this, in turn, is changing rainfall patterns and wind/cyclone speeds and the marine and coastal ecosystem. In the third part, we will discuss the importance of the ocean as a giant heat sink, without which the Earth would have become unlivable a long time back.

Ocean Current Systems

There are many global ocean current systems within which ocean currents operate. In general, oceans regulate

the Earth’s climate by transporting heat from one region to another. Let us take a look at the various ocean current systems.

» **‘Thermohaline’ circulation and the Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation (AMOC):** Ocean water circulates globally as ‘Thermohaline’ circulation and is determined by differences in temperature (Thermo) and salinity (Haline). These differences take the warm, salty water from the equator to the poles on the surface, and cold, dense water, which sinks, moves from the poles to the equator. This is also known as the ‘Great Ocean Conveyor Belt’, which redistributes heat from the tropics to the poles, transports nutrients through the oceans, and takes carbon dioxide to deep oceans, where it is stored. The Atlantic Meridional Overturning Circulation (AMOC), including the Gulf Stream, is a key part of this Thermohaline circulation and keeps Western Europe warmer than it would have been. It also impacts rainfall in Africa and North and South America and moderates the climate in the North Atlantic.

» **Equatorial Currents and ENSO (El Niño and La Niña Southern Oscillation):** This is basically the interaction

INVISIBLE CURRENTS EXERT AN EXTRAORDINARY INFLUENCE OVER WEATHER AND CLIMATE



between the Pacific Ocean and the atmosphere, leading to the El Niño (warm phase) and La Niña (cool phase) currents. El Niño causes warmer-than-usual sea surface temperatures in the eastern Pacific around the tropics. This leads to weakened trade winds, which, in turn, cause more rains in the Pacific but less-than-normal rains in Asia and Australia. Indian monsoons are also affected by the El Niño current. La Niña (cold phase) is the opposite and causes colder-than-usual waters in the eastern Pacific around the tropics, leading to the opposite effect and more

rains in Asia/Australia. The Southern Oscillation is the atmospheric part and refers to changes in the atmospheric pressure over the Pacific and its link to changes in ocean temperatures.

» **The Antarctic Circumpolar Current (ACC):** This is the largest and strongest ocean current circulating around Antarctica and isolates it, thus preserving the ice sheets. Apart from connecting the three largest oceans—the Pacific, Atlantic and Indian—it also plays an important part in deep-ocean circulation and nutrient mixing.

Warm and Cold Ocean Currents

Within the ocean current systems, there are warm and cold ocean currents that influence the global climate by carrying heat/ cold and nutrients, as well as interacting with the atmosphere. This has implications for marine life, wind systems and rainfall across the globe.

In the Atlantic Ocean, the main warm current is the Gulf Stream and North Atlantic Drift, which carries hot waters to the Western European coast and keeps these countries warmer than they would have been. The important cold currents in the Atlantic are the Labrador Current, which carries cold water from the North Atlantic southwards and meets the Gulf Stream, influencing the climate on the North American coast. Benguela is another cold current that cools the southwest coast of Africa and preserves the major fishing zones there.

In the Pacific Ocean, the Kuroshio Current (which takes its name from the place Kuroshio in Japan) is a warm current and a twin of the Atlantic’s Gulf Stream. This ocean current carries warm water to the Japanese coast and warms the East Asian region. The Humboldt (or Peru) Current is the

most important cold current in the Pacific and brings cold water from Antarctica towards the Equator, cooling the west coast of the South American continent. It is also extremely important because of its interaction with ENSO, discussed above, and influences the important marine ecosystems in the region. In the years when La Niña is active, trade winds make the Humboldt Current stronger, taking it to the South American coast, causing the cold water to rise along with the nutrients and encouraging the marine ecosystem. The opposite happens in the El Niño years, which reduces phytoplankton growth and affects the marine ecosystem negatively.

In the Indian Ocean, Agulhas is the most important warm current, which carries warm water to Africa’s east coast, influencing the climate there. The West Australian Current is the only cold current in the Indian Ocean, which originates from the Antarctic Circumpolar Current and flows northwards along the West Australian coast in the summer, cooling the area.





PV Sindhu

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

Playgrounds are more important than PlayStations. Such a message from Prime Minister Narendra Modi to athletes in India last week, while highlighting the Khelo India programme and its outreach, is important. On August 15, during the Independence Day speech from the ramparts of the Red Fort in New Delhi, PM Modi had spoken on the performance of the Indian athletes at the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow. For the PM to again mention it, keeping in mind India's desire to host the Summer Olympics in Ahmedabad in 2036, is a realistic dream, not a voyeuristic one.

So, where does India stand today in the world of sports? For the common man who now consumes sports on television, apps, websites and more, sport is non-stop. Name it, from athletics to yachting and sailing, every sport can be watched via live stream. When India did well at the condensed Commonwealth Games recently in Glasgow, some folks said standards at the Games were not high.

That was a cynic speaking, really, since 39 medals from able-bodied and para athletes was a rich reward. Once the Games concluded in Glasgow, I had the opportunity to speak to PT Usha, President of the Indian Olympic Association, as well as Harsh Sanghavi, Deputy Chief Minister of Gujarat. Usha spoke of how India would do well in 2030, while Sanghavi, a man committed to sports, spoke of how Amdavad (Ahmedabad) would be a gracious host.

Coming back to the statement from PM Narendra Modi, he follows sports closely. It is no exaggeration: when Modi meets athletes after their return from important sporting assignments, he is well-informed and can engage with them very well. The athletes feel important and motivated. Now, Modi has mentioned how India is not even able to compete in all the sporting disciplines which figure in a Summer Olympics. It is his dream that the youth of the nation play sports and focus on playfields rather than PlayStations, which only ruin the eyes.

For the record, India competed in only 16 sporting disciplines at the Paris 2024 Olympics. The next Olympics will be held in Los Angeles in 2028. With less than two years to go, the programme shows 36 sports disciplines in LA. It is hard to imagine India will even compete in 20 disciplines in LA, as the qualification criteria are so hard. It is clear that PM Modi wants India to improve in sports so that, by 2036, there can be more

Building a Sporting Nation

As India dreams of hosting the 2036 Olympics, expanding sporting participation and putting athletes first must become central to national planning

THE OLYMPIC DREAM DEMANDS INVESTMENT, OPPORTUNITY AND UNCOMPROMISING SPORTING MERIT

representation from India. This is not just a dream, but a vision, where the stakeholders on board have to work in unison. For those who say India has not yet touched the double digits in the medal tally at the Summer Olympics, that is a cynical view. The growth cannot be calculated or predicted so easily. The world of sports is hard, where the competition is fierce. All those who said India is not a sporting nation need to change their views.

Let's sample some results,

cricket aside. Treasa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand winning a doubles bronze medal at the BWF World Championship in New Delhi is big. Agreed, PV Sindhu fell short, Unnati Hooda was raw and Lakshya Sen did not peak. There is potential and promise. In badminton, India needs to keep working hard. The next challenge will be the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan.

Standards at the Asian Games are very high. Of course, India can aspire and dream big. Look at how the Indian women's hockey team showed courage and finished fifth in the FIH World Cup in Amstelveen recently. Indian men's hockey is known for flair and feel. As the nation celebrated legend Dhyan Chand's birth anniversary on August 29, emotions return. Dhyan Chand would be smiling from above; the Indian girls are now peaking.

Can India win a gold medal in women's hockey in Nagoya? Well, why not? This

is a committed bunch, led by coach Sjoerd Marijne, under the captaincy of Salima Tete. The kind of negativity spread before the World Cup was unwanted at home, where the change of dress from blue to orange came in for flak. What matters is the colour of performance. Indian eves did well at the World Cup, and the men will hope to make amends in the Asian Games. As defending champions and winners of two Olympic bronze medals, there is so much at stake.

In the run-up to the Asian Games, there is plenty of negative news around the selection of teams in various sports disciplines. Today, Indian sports is virtually run by babus (bureaucrats), leaving almost no room for National Sports Federations. To ride roughshod over the federations and even ad hoc committees in place is wrong. Agreed, the Indian Government is lavishly funding Indian sports. Apart



Manu Bhaker

from cricket, almost all sports disciplines owe it to the Sports Ministry, where the role played by the SAI (Sports Authority of India) is also important.

A stage has come now where selection matters are becoming sticky. There is a cap on participation, which means the Indian Government does not want too many athletes to go. If the selection criteria are very rigid, it will not help. The Sports Ministry has now cleared close to 500 athletes. Definitely, the numbers will go up. As it is, there has been a mess-up in the selection of tennis teams, notably doubles, women's rowing and some martial arts disciplines. How and who is clearing or chopping is well known. There are bureaucrats interfering, which means the National Sports Federations have no say.

There is still time for more athletes to be added, though football and handball are ruled out. If tennis doubles teams are being ignored, it's wrong. India does have a realistic chance. If curbing costs is the only reason for limiting athletes' participation in the Asian Games, how do we forget there was a time when former AIFF Presidents said they would pay for travel and lodging to fly out for an Asian Games?

In the next week, there is hope that the Sports Ministry will sit down and add more numbers to the list of athletes who will be cleared to fly out. Let it be based only on merit, not 'sifarish.' There is reason to believe more Indian athletes can go and attempt to win medals for India. Then again, there will be a fight over who goes as officials and support staff. It is clear that coaches and allied staff must be chosen on merit. It should not look like pleasing someone who has never been a coach or is completely out of touch with the athletes.

It is worth mentioning the positive and constructive role played by IOA President PT Usha. She has, in the past, managed to secure accreditation cards for coaches who were/are most necessary for athletes. Be it the late Jaspal Rana going as Manu Bhaker's personal coach to the Paris Olympics or, more recently, Murali Sreeshankar's and Neeraj Chopra's personal coaches getting accreditation cards, it has been positive. Manu won two bronze medals, a record effort.

Athletes have to be given top priority. Make relaxations if possible, so that India can participate and win more medals in Aichi-Nagoya. If India can win more medals in Asia, the next assault can be on the Summer Olympics, as suggested by PM Narendra Modi.

There is a need to promote sports even more. As Saina Nehwal had said in a recent interview, parents need to be sure that children being pushed into sports will be the right decision. She said only those who make it to the Top 25 in badminton can do well. There are many more sports disciplines where this applies.

Good luck, Indian athletes. May the best make the cut for the Asian Games.

A LOOK AT PAST 5 US OPEN MEN'S CHAMPIONS

With the US Open underway, here is a look at the past five men's singles champions



CARLOS ALCARAZ (2025)

The Spanish star won the trophy in 2025, beating arch-rival Jannik Sinner by 6–2, 3–6, 6–1, 6–4.



JANNIK SINNER (2024)

The Italian won the 2024 edition, coming out on top against home favourite Taylor Fritz, 6–3, 6–4, 7–5.



NOVAK DJOKOVIC (2023)

The Serbian icon won his last Grand Slam title in 2023, and this was the title he won, edging out Daniil Medvedev in the final by 6–3, 7–6(7–5), 6–3.



CARLOS ALCARAZ (2022)

In the 2022 edition, Alcaraz beat Casper Ruud 6–4, 2–6, 7–6(7–1), 6–3 in the final.



DANIIL MEDVEDEV (2021)

This has been Russian star's sole Grand Slam win, having beaten Novak Djokovic, 6–4, 6–4, 6–4 in the final.

DOLLY PARTON'S 'JOLENE'

The song of vulnerability that still haunts us

Although Parton had belted out many hits, 'Jolene' still remains etched in the memory of music lovers

ASIF ULLAH KHAN

Dolly Parton, the country superstar, died on August 25 in Nashville after a brief battle with cancer. Although Parton had belted out many hits, 'Jolene' still remains etched in the memory of music lovers. There is something unsettling about 'Jolene', even though it is one of the most beautiful and enduring songs Dolly Parton ever wrote.

The song, unlike 'I Will Survive' by Gloria Gaynor, showed that female pop singers were still battling with their identity as independent women. Like 'I Will Survive', the woman was happy to show the door to an ungrateful man; the woman in 'Jolene' was literally begging 'the other woman' to leave her man while admitting that she is not as beautiful as her.

We all know the story behind the song. Parton had explained that 'Jolene', released in 1973, was inspired by a red-haired bank teller whom she saw flirting with her husband, Carl Dean. Parton, as the song goes, found the woman more beautiful in every sense of the word. In the song, Parton describes every feature of the woman:

*"Your beauty is beyond compare
With flaming locks of auburn hair
With ivory skin and eyes of emerald green
Your smile is like a breath of spring
Your skin is soft like summer rain..."*

And she literally fell at her feet to leave her man. It's interesting to know that she and Carl remained married for nearly 60 years, from 1966 until his death in March 2025.

Was she not sure of Carl's love or like any other woman, did she

feel insecure and vulnerable seeing a woman younger and more beautiful than her? The song depicts the vulnerability of a woman trying to keep her husband. She is not strong enough to challenge the woman or tell her husband that if he falls for her, she will slam the door on him.

Many female writers saw the song as 'anti-feminist' and disliked the idea of begging another woman not to steal her man. But the answer came from Beyoncé when she turned the lyrics of 'Jolene' upside down. Beyoncé, instead of begging or pleading, warned the woman by saying:

*"Jolene, Jolene, Jolene, Jolene
I'm warnin' you, don't come for my man (Jolene)
Jolene, Jolene, Jolene, Jolene
Don't take the chance because you think you can..."*

Parton publicly praised Beyoncé's bold, confrontational reimagining of 'Jolene' on the 2024 album 'Cowboy Carter', saying "Beyoncé is giving that girl some trouble and she deserves it."

In sharp contrast to Beyoncé's version, Parton shows herself powerless in front of the other woman. Instead of asking her husband to keep away from that woman, she is pleading with her to show restraint. On the other side, Beyoncé is so confident that she calls herself queen and is at the

same time sure of her husband's love when she says:

*"I know my man better than he knows himself
(Yeah, what?)
I can easily understand
Why you're attracted to my man?
But you don't want this smoke,
so shoot your shot with someone else (You heard me)..."*



THE SONG, UNLIKE 'I WILL SURVIVE' BY GLORIA GAYNOR, SHOWED THAT FEMALE POP SINGERS WERE STILL BATTLING WITH THEIR IDENTITY AS INDEPENDENT WOMEN

The irony becomes even sharper when we remember who Dolly Parton herself was. She was hardly a woman without agency. She became one of the most successful female songwriters and performers in a male-dominated Nashville music industry. Yet in 'Jolene', she enters the mind of a woman who feels powerless precisely because another woman is more beautiful.

Many years later, Elizabeth Gilbert in her book 'All the Way to the River: Love, Loss and Liberation' questioned this extreme codependency as depicted in 'Jolene'. Gilbert argues that a woman's happiness should never be entirely at the mercy of someone else's actions as in the song. In hindsight, we can analyse 'Jolene' threadbare, but we do not know the mental makeup of Parton at the time she wrote it. Was she expressing her own insecurity and vulnerability or was she depicting the reality of a section of women who were still conditioned to be submissive in relationships?



OPERATION SAFED SAGAR

'It was conceived as special ops franchise'

Netflix India's Series Head Tanya Bhami said the streamer is looking to build a franchise around its latest hit series

Netflix is looking to build a franchise around its latest hit series 'Operation Safed Sagar' with special military operations serving as the central idea for future stories, said Tanya Bami, Series Head at 'Netflix India'.

The six-episode military drama, which tells the story of the Indian Air Force's role in the 1999 Kargil War, has emerged as a global success for the streamer. Since its debut on the OTT platform on August 7, the show has remained on Netflix's 'Global Top 10 Non-English TV List' for two consecutive weeks, ranking No 2 the previous week, while making it to the Top 10 in 40 countries and reaching No 1 in 10 countries.

Bami said the streamer is already deep into writing the next project with the team behind 'Operation Safed Sagar' and its collaborators working on more stories. "Our outlook for 'Operation Safed Sagar' was to create a franchise where operations is the franchise thought. So, we're deep into development on a couple of things. But each one, the next operation has to go higher than this one. So, that's a tall task," Bami told PTI.

"We're deep in the writing of something. And we have Kushal, Abhijeet, 'Matchbox', the Air Force - all these deep collaborators who are bringing us more stories. So, lots more historicals," she said.

Kushal Srivastava and Abhijeet Singh Parmar were the creative forces behind 'Operation Safed Sagar', which was directed by Oni Sen and produced by 'Matchbox Shots' and 'Feel Good Films'.

Bami said the focus for the franchise would not simply be on repeating the formula of the first series but on finding compelling stories and taking the scale and storytelling forward.

"I think at the heart of it is what is the core of the story and how are we able to take what we've done higher, bring something new and fresh to keep the audiences engaged and to have such amazing creative voices as Kushal, Abhijeet and Oni really bring forward the story and bring it to life in a way that hasn't been seen before," she said.

'Operation Safed Sagar' follows the Indian Air Force's Golden Arrows Squadron and their high-altitude air campaign during Kargil, including the extraordinary challenge of conducting air operations at mountainous elevations while being prohibited from crossing the Line of Control. The story focuses on a group of seasoned and young fighter pilots who undertake



THE SERIES HAS RECEIVED A STRONG RESPONSE FROM BOTH CRITICS AND AUDIENCES

high-risk combat missions while navigating the emotional and personal costs of war. It features an ensemble cast of Jimmy Shergill, Siddharth, Abhay Verma, Adil Hussain, Mihir Ahuja, Taa-ruk Raina, Arnav Bhasin, Amrita Bagchi, Manu Rishi Chadha, Dia Mirza and Pranjana Koli.

The series has received a strong response from both critics and audiences, with praise for its gripping storytelling, realistic portrayal of the Indian Air Force, performances and immersive aerial action.

According to Bami, the universal appeal of 'Operation Safed Sagar' lies in its themes of national pride, sacrifice and the desire to protect one's country. "The universality of this story and in the times that we are living is actually a very deep connection. And I think given that universality and that feeling of the need to protect your country. It's a feeling that everybody connects with, regardless of where you're from," she said.

"And then there is really the magnanimity of what has been achieved through this mission with the kind of respect and restraint, yet the determination to actually win and a whole, like all three forces coming together to score this big win is again something that I think anybody anywhere in the world who is even mildly sort of patriotic or connects with their country would connect with a story like this," Bami added.

"It's humbling to see the armed forces actually connect with the story, to feel seen, depicted, honoured and displayed with such pride across 'Netflix' all over the world and how they've been really celebrating the story," Bami said. PTI



Fresh out of the OTT box!

Here is a selection of OTT K-Drama content for you to binge watch this weekend!

OUR CORRESPONDENT

2026 seems to be the year of interesting and eye-catching Korean content for fans and audiences to binge-watch in their free time.

From selected streaming sites, one can enjoy the series and films from the list below!

Mousetrap (Netflix)



Now available to be streamed, it stars Ryu Jun Yeol, Sul Kyung Gul and Lee Kyu Hyung. The mystery thriller follows a novelist who loses everything due to a mysterious stranger named 'The Rat'. This pushes the novelist to join forces with a loan-shark-turned-private investigator to uncover The Rat's identity.

Four Hands, Two Sonatas (Netflix)

Starring Song Kang, Lee Jun Young and Jang Gyu Ri, the series is a coming-of-age romance



that explores the story of two piano prodigies whose paths align in a heated rivalry towards the same ambition at first, until life, dreams and feelings happen.

The Affair Was Just The Beginning (Viki)



This perfect black comedy drama is already a big topic among the fans and audiences as it follows a popular influencer couple who keep their picture-perfect happy family façade in front of everyone, but behind the curtains? It's the complete opposite, with secrets ready to mess up everything for the couple! It stars Kim Hye Soo, Kim Ji Hoon, Cho Yeo Jeong and Kim Jae Chul in lead roles.



Flex X Cop S2 (Jio Hotstar)

Actor Ahn Bo Hyun returns in the second season as Jin Yisoo, a chaebol heir-turned-detective who uses his wealth and powerful connections to solve cases. However, he finds new, unexpected changes at his workplace amid chaos and shenanigans. The new season also stars Jung Eun Chae, Kang Sang Jun and Kim Shin Bi.